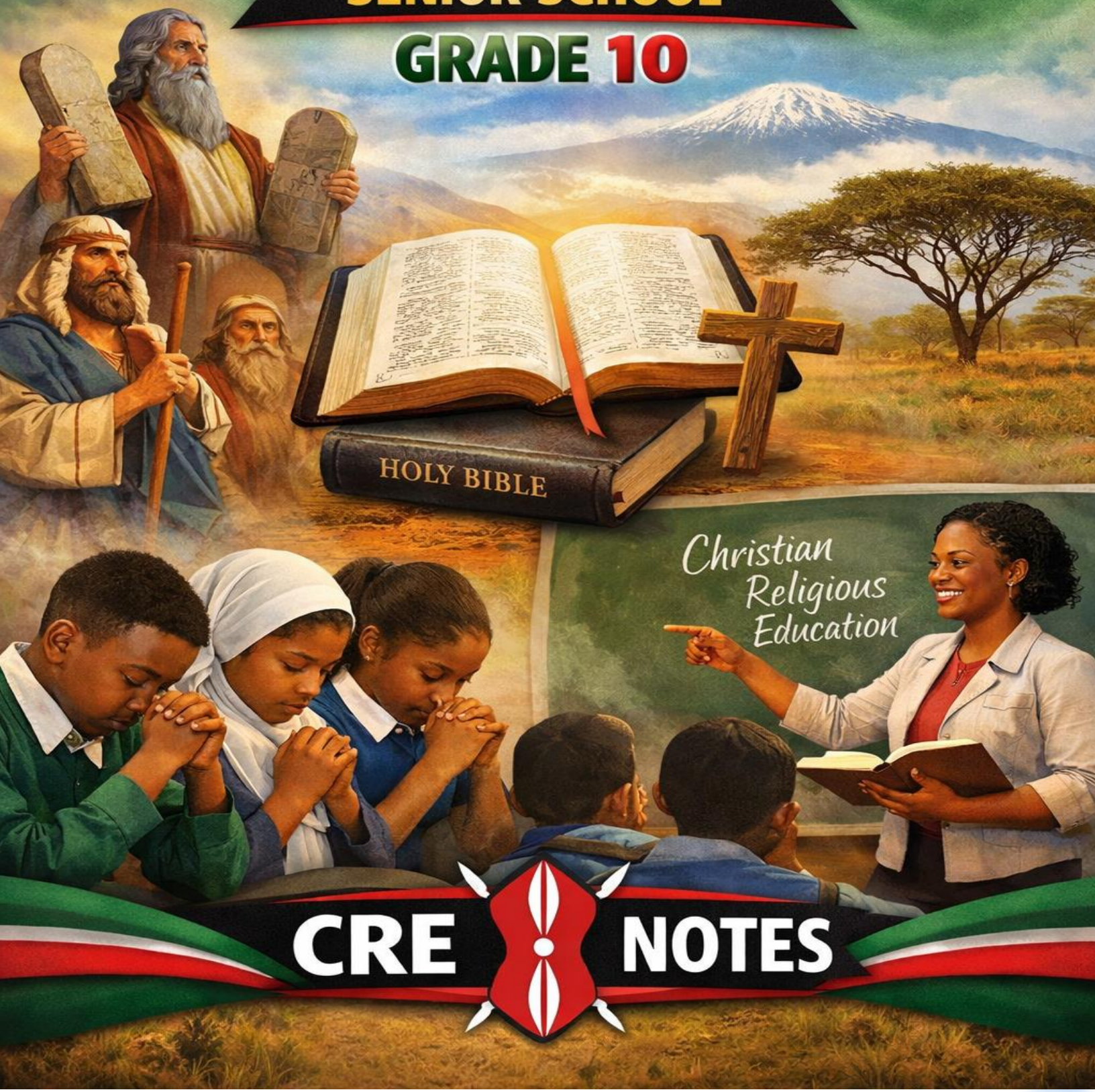


COMPETENCE BASED EDUCATION

SENIOR SCHOOL

GRADE 10



CRE

NOTES

1. THE OLD TESTAMENT

1.1. THE HOLY BIBLE

1.2. Bible as the 'inspired' word of God

Isaiah 46:10, Isaiah 55:11, Jeremiah 1:9, Proverbs 30:5, Psalms 119:160, Psalms 12:6

- Inspired means feeling motivated or encouraged to do something.
- The word *inspired* in the Biblical context means 'God-breathed' or 'God-spoken.' The Scripture came from God. He breathed (spoke) the words He wanted the authors to write.
- The Bible is referred to as *the inspired word of God* because:
 - a) God used the Holy Spirit to guide human authors in writing the Bible. God's power worked through the writers, controlling what was being written. The authors wrote what God intended them to communicate to other people.
 - b) It shows the true nature of God. He is everlasting, righteous and truthful.
 - c) Through it, God communicates to humankind.
 - d) It contains words spoken by God. The words in the Bible came from God's own mouth.
 - e) It reveals the will of God for humankind. The Bible accomplishes God's purposes for His people.
 - f) It is a source of inspiration to humankind. The Bible comforts those who read it.
- God, through the Holy Spirit, used human authors to write what He revealed in the Bible. Some of these authors were kings. God influenced various human authors to put His message into writing.
- The authors of the Bible wrote at different times in history and were influenced by the religious, historical and political situations of their time.
- Some of these authors include Moses, David, Paul, Obadiah, Habakkuk, Solomon and Amos.

1.3. Old Testament books according to their categories

- The Old Testament consists of 39 books, divided into 4 categories:
 - a) **The law books**
Also referred to as the Pentateuch or Torah, these are the first five books of the Bible. They contain the history of the Israelites from creation to the time they entered the Promised Land, Canaan. The books are:
 - o Genesis
 - o Exodus
 - o Leviticus
 - o Numbers
 - o Deuteronomy
 - b) **Historical books**
These contain the history of the Israelites from the time they entered and settled in the Promised Land (Canaan) up to the period after the exile of the Kingdoms of Israel and Judah. There are 12 books in this category:
 - o Joshua
 - o Judges
 - o Ruth

- 1 Samuel
- 2 Samuel
- 1 Kings
- 2 Kings
- 1 Chronicles
- 2 Chronicles
- Ezra
- Nehemiah
- Esther

c) Poetic books

Also called Writings or Wisdom Books, these 5 books are:

- Job
- Psalms
- Proverbs
- Ecclesiastes
- Song of Solomon

d) Prophetic books

These contain prophecies concerning the people of Israel. There are 17 books, divided into Major Prophets and Minor Prophets:

- Major prophets
 - Isaiah
 - Jeremiah
 - Lamentations
 - Ezekiel
 - Daniel
- Minor prophets
 - Hosea
 - Joel
 - Amos
 - Obadiah
 - Jonah
 - Micah
 - Nahum
 - Habakkuk
 - Zephaniah
 - Haggai
 - Zechariah
 - Malachi

1.4. Literary forms used in writing the bible

- Different authors of the Bible used different styles in writing. These styles are referred to as literary forms.

- The writers were influenced by different circumstances and they wrote for different reasons and audiences. This caused the language and expressions used to differ from one another.
- The authors used both artistic and simple language to help readers remember more easily and to make their writings stand out.
- Some of the literary forms that were used include:
 - a) **Legislative texts:** These are legal documents that support and guide the law-making process. The author of the book of *Leviticus* used legislative texts in writing. These texts guided the Israelites in areas such as sacrifices, the ordination of priests, the consecration of the tabernacle, dietary laws, marriage, holiness, tithing, childbirth, diseases and clothing.
 - b) **Wise sayings:** The book of *Proverbs* is written using wise sayings. These provide guidance on how to live wisely and avoid falling into temptation.
 - c) **Prophetic speeches (Jeremiah):** These are the words of a prophet and are part of the artistic styles used in the book of *Jeremiah*.
 - d) **Prayers (Nehemiah):** A prayer is a sincere request for help or an expression of thanks addressed to God. Prayer is a form of interaction with God and can be said individually or communally.
 - e) **Love songs (The Song of Solomon):** This book poetically presents events such as courtship and marriage. It also offers encouragement toward love and provides assurance in relationships.
 - f) **Philosophical essays (Job):** This literary form explores deep questions about human existence and the nature of God. The book of *Job* uses philosophical essays to tell the story of Job and his trust in God in situations beyond his control.
 - g) **Religious epics (Exodus):** These are narrative poems or stories that tell of legends or historical heroes and their interactions with God. For example, *Exodus* narrates the work of Moses. It describes how God delivered the Israelites from slavery and made them His special people. The book provides God's laws, including the Ten Commandments and recounts the covenant made with Moses at Mount Sinai.
 - h) **Epistles:** These are letters used to communicate messages. The epistles, found in the New Testament, were written by apostles to individuals or churches. They provide guidance on how Christians should live and behave.
 - i) **Gospels:** The authors of the Gospels used a variety of literary forms including narratives, doctrines and parables. These books tell the story of Jesus Christ and God's Kingdom. The book of *Luke* is one of the four Gospels.

1.5. Utilizing the poetic form to present a song from the book of Psalms

Psalm 19:7-10

The law of the Lord is perfect; it gives new strength. The commands of the Lord are trustworthy, giving wisdom to those who lack it. The laws of the Lord are right, and those who obey them are happy. The commands of the Lord are just and give understanding to the mind. Reverence for the Lord is good; it will continue forever. The judgements of the Lord are just; they are always fair. They are more desirable than the finest gold; they are sweeter than the purest honey.

The law of the Lord is perfect,
Refreshing the soul each day.
The statutes of God are trustworthy,
They guide the simple on their way.

The precepts of the Lord are right,
Giving joy to the heart so true.
The commands of the Lord are radiant,
Giving light to all we do.

The fear of the Lord is pure,
Forever it will stand.
The decrees of God are firm,
Just and true are His commands.

More precious than gold, than purest gold,
Sweeter than honey's flow—
Are the words of the Lord to those who hear,
In His truth we come to know.

1.6. METHODS OF STUDYING THE BIBLE

- Bible study is the act of reading and analysing the bible as a form of personal or communal spiritual practice.
- It is a way to learn more about God, his plan for humanity and love.
- The five methods used in studying the holy bible are:
 1. **Inductive method** - This method involves a deep understanding of keywords, themes and the context of a passage. It helps determine the application of the text in daily life and encourages personal engagement with the Scriptures.
 2. **Devotional method** - This is a personal study of the Bible that involves reflection and the practical application of Scripture. It includes prayerfully meditating on a passage and applying its meaning to one's life.
 3. **Biographical method** - This approach focuses on the life of a specific Bible character. It involves analyzing their actions, choices and experiences to understand their character and draw spiritual lessons from their story.
 4. **Topical method** - This method involves studying specific topics or themes found in the Bible, such as love, forgiveness or faith. It helps the reader gain a broad understanding of what the Bible says about a particular subject.
 5. **Word study method** - This method involves examining the original words or terms used in Scripture (often from Hebrew or Greek) to gain a deeper understanding of their meanings and significance.

1.7. Benefits of studying the Holy Bible

- It helps us grow spiritually and develop good values. It gives wisdom, guidance and encouragement while strengthening our faith and connection with God. Through its teachings, we find comfort, inspiration and direction for daily life.
- It deepens our relationship with God by helping us understand His character, His will and His love.
- It provides direction for making wise decisions in life.
- The Holy Bible reminds us of God's promises and His faithfulness throughout. This helps build trust and confidence in God's ability to work in our lives during difficult times.
- The Holy Bible brings hope and peace, especially during trials. It reminds us that God is always with us.
- The Holy Bible equips us with spiritual tools to resist temptation and stay strong in faith.
- It teaches us how to pray.

1.8. Utilizing inductive method to study specific bible texts

- The inductive method of studying the Bible is a systematic approach to understanding Scripture by focusing on three main steps: observation, interpretation and application.
- It involves studying a Scripture verse by observing its details, interpreting its meaning based on those observations and applying the lessons learned.
 - a) Observation - In this step, you read the passage carefully and observe what is actually happening. This includes noting important details in your notebook.
 - b) Interpretation - In this step, you seek to understand the meaning of the Scripture. Interpretation answers the question: *"What did the author intend to communicate?"*
 - c) Application - This is the final step, where you reflect on how the passage applies to your daily life. This allows your reading of Scripture to transform you.
- Utilize the inductive method to study the following bible texts:
 - ❖ Mathew 13:44-46
 - ❖ Romans 8:28-26

1.9. Themes of 'integrity' and 'chastity' for applying in our day-to-day lives

Proverbs 12:22 ; 1 Corinthians 15:32 ; Psalms 119:9 ; 1 Thessalonians 4:3

- Integrity refers to having strong moral principles, being honest and doing the right thing at all times, even when no one is watching.
- Chastity is the practice of being pure and holy.
- Ways of applying integrity in our lives include:
 - ❖ being honest and truthful,
 - ❖ keeping promises and commitments,
 - ❖ doing the right thing, even when no one is watching,
 - ❖ treating others fairly and with respect,
 - ❖ taking responsibility for your own actions.
- Ways of applying the virtue of chastity in our lives include:
 - ❖ cultivating self-control,

- ❖ behaving and dressing in a modest manner,
- ❖ being mindful of media content that promotes immorality,
- ❖ practicing purity in thoughts and behaviour,
- ❖ honouring commitments in marriage and single life,
- ❖ having a clean mind and thoughts.

1.10. Using the biographical method to study the book of Jonah

- The biographical method of studying the Bible focuses on a specific person mentioned in the Scriptures.
- It involves gathering information about their life from various biblical passages.
- It includes analyzing their character, actions and experiences.
- This method helps uncover valuable lessons and truths through their life story.
- Studying Jonah using this method helps to:
 - Obtain a clearer picture of his motivations, struggles and victories.
 - Discover real-life examples of faith, disobedience, repentance and obedience.
 - Learn how to overcome personal challenges.
 - Encourage self-reflection and the practical application of biblical truths.

1.11. Applying lessons learnt from the scriptures in daily life

- Practicing forgiveness - Letting go of anger and forgiving others as taught in passages like Matthew 6:14-15.
- Showing love and kindness - Demonstrating love to others through actions as instructed in 1 Corinthians 13 and John 13:34.
- Being honest and truthful - Speaking and acting with integrity, following the example of Proverbs 12:22.
- Helping those in need - Caring for the poor, sick or vulnerable, in line with teachings from James 1:27 and Matthew 25:35-40.
- Living in obedience to God - Following God's commandments and guidance from the Bible such as in Deuteronomy 5:33.
- Praying regularly - Maintaining communication with God as shown in 1 Thessalonians 5:17.
- Trusting God during challenges - Holding onto faith in difficult times, as encouraged in Proverbs 3:5-6 and Romans 8:28.
- Avoiding sinful behavior - Turning away from actions that go against God's word, based on scriptures like Galatians 5:19-21.
- Seeking wisdom through the Word - Making decisions guided by biblical wisdom, such as that found in James 1:5.
- Being thankful - Practicing gratitude in all circumstances, as taught in 1 Thessalonians 5:18.

1.12. Reading the word of God daily for spiritual growth

- Strengthens faith - Regular reading helps deepen your trust in God and His promises (Romans 10:17).

- Guides daily decisions - Scripture provides wisdom and direction for everyday life (Psalm 119:105).
- Encourages spiritual maturity - Daily study helps believers grow in understanding and character (2 Timothy 3:16-17).
- Renews the mind - God's Word transforms thinking and aligns it with His will (Romans 12:2).
- Provides comfort and hope - In times of struggle, the Bible offers peace, encouragement and reassurance (Psalm 46:1).
- Equips for spiritual battles - Scripture serves as a spiritual weapon against temptation and doubt (Ephesians 6:17).
- Builds a closer relationship with God - Consistent reading fosters a deeper connection with Him through His Word (John 15:7).
- Encourages obedience and righteous living - The Word teaches how to live in a way that pleases God (James 1:22).

1.13. REDEMPTION AFTER THE FALL OF MAN

- Redemption refers to the ability to obtain something back after it has been lost, by paying a ransom.
- It signifies deliverance from bondage, sin and evil.
- In the Bible, redemption is made possible through the sacrificial death and resurrection of Jesus Christ.
- Through Him, believers are restored to a right relationship with God and given the hope of eternal life.

1.14. Origin and consequences of sin

Genesis 3 ; Genesis 4:1-15 ; Genesis 6:1-14 ; Genesis 6:17-18 ; Genesis 11:1-9

- Sin entered the world when Adam and Eve disobeyed God by eating the fruit from the forbidden tree.
- When human beings disobeyed God, He punished them.
- In Genesis 3, we learn that:
 - The relationship between God and humankind changed to one of shame and fear. Adam and Eve hid from God after realizing they were naked.
 - Pain became part of the human experience. The woman was to experience pain during childbirth.
 - The good relationship between God and human beings was ruined and they were sent out of the Garden of Eden.
 - Enmity arose between humankind and wild animals.
 - The serpent was cursed and was to crawl on its belly and eat dust.
 - The ground was cursed, and humankind was to toil and struggle to meet their daily needs.
- From Genesis 4:1-15, we learn that:
 - The earth became filled with hatred, jealousy, and anger in God's eyes.
 - Murderous feelings entered the hearts of human beings.

- Humankind began killing one another due to uncontrolled anger, jealousy, and selfishness.
- For example, Cain rose against his brother Abel and killed him.
- From Genesis 6:1-14 and Genesis 6:17-18, we learn that:
 - Forbidden marriages between human beings and heavenly beings occurred.
 - The earth became corrupt and filled with violence.
 - As a result, God declared a global destruction through the flood.
 - He punished His creation by sending a flood to destroy all living things, except for Noah and those in the ark.
- From Genesis 11:1-9, we learn that:
 - Humankind rebelled against God due to greed for power and lack of knowledge.
 - God confused their language so they could no longer understand one another.
 - This confusion led to the dispersion of various human races across the earth.

1.15. God's plan of salvation after the fall of man

John 1:1-5, 14 ; Colossians 1:12-14 ; Isaiah 63:5 ; 2 Peter 3:9 ; Ephesians 1:3-7 ; 1 Corinthians 15:1-4, 12-14, 20-28

- God became a man named Jesus Christ. God took on human form to dwell among us and reveal His love and truth. Jesus Christ is the Word made flesh, fully God and fully man. This was the first step in God's plan to restore the broken relationship between humanity and Himself.
- He died on the cross to redeem us. Jesus willingly gave His life as a sacrifice to pay the penalty for our sins. His death was the ransom that brought forgiveness, freedom, and reconciliation with God. Through His blood, we are redeemed from the power of sin and death.
- Christ rose from the dead. Jesus conquered death and proved that He is Lord over all. His resurrection guarantees eternal life to all who believe in Him. It is the foundation of our faith and hope in the final victory over sin.
- **John 1:1-5, 14** - Describes Jesus as the eternal Word who was with God and is God. Verse 14 emphasizes that the Word became flesh and lived among us.
- **Colossians 1:12-14** - Speaks of our inheritance in the Kingdom and redemption through Christ's blood.
- **Isaiah 63:5** - Symbolically shows that God alone brought salvation, for no one else could.
- **2 Peter 3:9** - God is patient, not wanting anyone to perish, but for all to come to repentance.
- **Ephesians 1:3-7** - Speaks of God's blessings and how we have redemption and forgiveness through Jesus.
- **1 Corinthians 15:1-4, 12-14, 20-28** - Paul explains the importance of the resurrection in the gospel message. Without the resurrection, our faith would be meaningless; but Christ has risen, securing our hope.

1.16. Ways in which Christians respond to God's redemptive work

John 12:24-25

1. By letting go of selfish desires and personal ambitions. Just as a seed must "die" to produce fruit, believers sacrifice worldly pleasures to live for God's purposes.

2. Through serving others, Christians demonstrate their response to God's redemptive work. They invest in the spiritual growth of others by sharing the gospel and offering practical help.
3. Turning away from sinful behaviours and embracing a life that reflects godliness and righteousness.
4. Dedicating their lives to spreading the message of God's redemptive love and glorifying Him in their actions and words.
5. Christians choose to follow Jesus even when it requires sacrifices, challenges, or opposition.

1.17. STEWARDSHIP OVER CREATION

- Good stewardship is the responsible use of God's gifts, including time, money and talents.
- It also involves caring for the people, animals and land that God created.
- To be a good steward means to responsibly and faithfully manage all the resources entrusted to us by God.

1.18. Qualities of good stewardship

1 Chronicles 29:11-12 ; Proverbs 3:5-6 ; Proverbs 11:25 ; Proverbs 1:7 ; Jeremiah 29:12-13 Proverbs 6:6-9 ; Proverbs 13:4 ; Proverbs 22:4

1. Diligence - the quality of doing your work carefully and thoroughly.
2. Ownership - this is God's supreme authority over all creation. Everything belongs to God, and humans are just stewards or caretakers of His creation.
3. Prayerfulness - is approaching situations with a mind focused on seeking God's guidance, wisdom and will through prayer.
4. Selflessness - is the quality of caring more about the welfare of other people above your own, without seeking personal gain or recognition.
5. Trust - Refers to complete confidence, reliance and faith in God's promises and guidance.
6. Wisdom - is the quality of having knowledge and making good judgement.

1.19. Scriptures on environmental pollution

- Human beings are called to conserve the environment as stewards of God's creation.
- The Scriptures emphasize that humans should conserve the environment by acting as caretakers, ensuring sustainability and using resources responsibly.
- The Bible teaches us the following about environmental conservation:
- In **Genesis 1:26-28**:
 - o God gave human beings dominion over the earth.
 - o This dominion implies responsible stewardship, not exploitation.
 - o We are to care for and manage the environment wisely.
 - o Human beings are not only stewards over the "things" of the earth but also over one another and the relationships we share.
 - o We are expected to act upon God's creation using knowledge and wisdom.
- In **Genesis 2:15-16**:
 - o God placed Adam in the Garden of Eden to cultivate and care for it.

- This highlights our duty to nurture and protect the environment.
- As stewards, we are responsible for caring for and protecting everything under our authority.
- In **Exodus 23:10-11**:
 - God commanded that the land should be left to rest every seventh year.
 - This allowed the poor and wild animals to benefit from the land.
 - It teaches us the principle of sustainable land use and care for all creation, including the marginalized and non-human life.

1.20. Class project on conservation of the environment through tree planting

1. **Planning the tree-planting day.** Meet as a class with your teacher to discuss the importance of tree planting. Set clear objectives: e.g., number of trees to be planted, area to be covered and expected impact. Assign roles and responsibilities to team members (e.g., logistics, communication, materials, documentation).
2. **Seek school administration approval.** Write a formal request to the school administration outlining: purpose of the project, date and location of the activity and required support (transport, watering cans, funding, etc.). Ensure that the project aligns with school policies and calendars.
3. **Notify the local authorities.** Inform the area chief or local administrator at least one week in advance. Explain the community involvement aspect and request any necessary permissions. Invite them to attend or support the event if possible.
4. **Conduct a site visit.** Organise a pre-visit to identify a suitable location for planting. Assess the condition of the land, soil type, water availability and existing vegetation. Map out the planting area and mark zones based on spacing and tree type. Take photos or notes for reference.
5. **Mobilise and engage the community.** Create awareness through posters, school assemblies, or community meetings. Invite parents, local leaders, youth groups and environmental officials to participate. Explain how tree planting benefits the community: shade, rain, clean air, erosion control, etc.
6. **Educate on environmental conservation.** Prepare and present short talks on: the role of trees in combating climate change, biblical basis for stewardship (Genesis 2:15) and ways to care for planted trees. Distribute handouts or create awareness boards.
7. **Plant the trees.** Gather the required materials: seedlings, hoes, watering cans, manure, mulch, etc. Demonstrate the correct way to dig holes, plant, water and protect young trees. Ensure that trees are planted with proper spacing and soil support. Assign each tree a caretaker or group to monitor growth.
8. **Post-planting care and follow-up.** Create a schedule for watering, weeding and checking on the trees. Collaborate with the school gardener, environment club or a local group for long-term care. Put up signs encouraging protection of the planted area.
9. **Document and report the project.** Record key moments: photos, number of trees planted, challenges faced and community response. Write a comprehensive report including: introduction and objectives, planning and implementation process, outcomes and lessons learned and recommendations for future project
10. Present the report to the school and community leaders.

1.21. THE EXODUS

1.22. The call of Moses as guided by the holy scriptures

Exodus 3:1-22

- Mount Horeb, also known as Mt Sinai, means *mountain of God*.
- While looking after his father-in-law's flock near Mount Horeb, an angel appeared to Moses in a burning bush that was not being consumed.
- As he went closer to see what was happening, God called him by name and instructed him to remove his sandals because he was standing on holy ground.
- God introduced Himself as the God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob. Moses hid his face because he was afraid to look at God.
- He told Moses that He had seen the suffering of the Israelites in Egypt and He was ready to liberate them.
- He commanded Moses to go to Pharaoh and lead the Israelites out of slavery. When Moses doubted his ability, God assured him of His presence, saying, "I will be with you."
- Moses then asked what name he should use for God, and God replied, "I AM WHO I AM." God instructed him to gather the Israelite elders and tell them about their freedom. He warned that Pharaoh would resist, but through signs and wonders, He would compel him to let them go.
- In the end, the Israelites would not only be freed but would also leave with silver, gold, and clothing from the Egyptians.
- This marked the beginning of Moses' journey as Israel's leader and deliverer.

1.23. The discourse between God and Moses

Exodus 4:1-17

- Moses was still uncertain about leading the Israelites and asked God, "What if they do not believe me or listen to me?"
- To reassure him, God gave him three signs:
 - ❖ He turned Moses' staff into a snake and back into a staff.
 - ❖ He made Moses' hand leprous and then healed it.
 - ❖ He told Moses that if people still doubted, he could pour water from the Nile onto the ground, and it would turn into blood.
- These signs were meant to prove that God had sent him and to convince the Israelites to follow him.
- Even after these miracles, Moses still hesitated, saying he was not a good speaker. God reminded him that He is the one who gives people the ability to speak and promised to help him.
- But when Moses asked God to send someone else, God became angry. However, He allowed Aaron, Moses' brother, to speak on his behalf while Moses would relay God's instructions.
- God then commanded Moses to take his staff and go, as it would be used to perform signs and wonders in Egypt.
- From the discourse between God and Moses, you learn that:
 - ❖ God is loving and caring.

- ❖ God is beyond human understanding.
- ❖ God chooses whoever He wants to carry out His plans.
- ❖ God expects total obedience and faith on the part of those He chooses.

1.24. The Ten Plagues of Egypt

Exodus 7:14 - 11:10

1. Plague of blood (*Exodus 7:14-24*) - God turned the waters of the Nile River into blood. All the water in Egypt became undrinkable, and the fish died.
2. Plague of frogs (*Exodus 8:1-15*) - Frogs swarmed out of the river and invaded homes, bedrooms, kitchens and ovens.
3. Plague of gnats (or lice) (*Exodus 8:16-19*) - Dust turned into gnats, which infested people and animals throughout Egypt.
4. Plague of flies (*Exodus 8:20-32*) - Swarms of flies filled the houses of the Egyptians and the land, causing great distress.
5. Plague on livestock (*Exodus 9:1-7*) - A deadly disease killed the Egyptians' horses, donkeys, camels, cattle, sheep and goats. The livestock of the Israelites remained unharmed.
6. Plague of boils (*Exodus 9:8-12*) - Painful boils broke out on the skin of the Egyptians and their animals.
7. Plague of hail (*Exodus 9:13-35*) - A powerful storm of hail and fire struck down crops, people, and animals left outdoors. It was the worst hailstorm in Egypt's history.
8. Plague of locusts (*Exodus 10:1-20*) - Swarms of locusts devoured all the plants, crops, and trees left after the hail.
9. Plague of darkness (*Exodus 10:21-29*) - Thick darkness covered Egypt for three days. The Israelites, however, had light in their dwellings.
10. Plague on the firstborn (*Exodus 11:1-10*) - God declared that every firstborn male in Egypt would die, from Pharaoh's son to the firstborn of animals. This was the final plague that would lead to Israel's release.

1.25. Attributes of God from the Ten Plagues

- The ten plagues in Egypt were a demonstration of God's power and judgement against Pharaoh for refusing to release the Israelites.
- Each plague was not just a punishment but also a demonstration of God's control over nature and false gods.
- Through these events, God revealed His character to both the Israelites and the Egyptians.
- The attributes of God from the ten plagues are:
 - a) God is almighty and powerful
 - b) God is just
 - c) God gives everyone a chance to repent
 - d) God fulfils His promises
 - e) God is loving and caring
 - f) God expects total obedience and faith from the people He sends
 - g) God empowers the people He sends to perform miracles and do His work

- h) God is patient, but His judgement is certain
- i) God is sovereign over all creation and human authority

1.26. The Passover

Exodus 12:1-31

- Moses and Aaron were instructed by God to tell the congregation of Israel that on the tenth day of the month, they were to select a one-year-old male lamb or goat for each household.
- This lamb was to be kept until the fourteenth day of the month, then slaughtered in the evening.
- Some of the lamb's blood was to be applied on the two doorposts and the lintel of the houses. The lamb was to be roasted and eaten with unleavened bread and bitter herbs. No meat was to be eaten raw or boiled with water. Any leftovers were to be burned by morning. The Israelites were to eat the meal in haste, for it was the Lord's Passover.
- God announced that He would pass through the land of Egypt and strike down all the firstborn males—both human and animal. The blood would be a sign upon the houses where the Israelites lived. God would **pass over** their houses, sparing them from the plague. This act was also a judgement on all the gods of Egypt. The Israelites were instructed to keep this observance as a lasting memory for generations to come.
- At midnight, God struck down all the firstborns in Egypt. Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and urgently commanded the Israelites to leave Egypt immediately. The Egyptians were eager to see the Israelites depart.
- The Israelites, with their sandals on their feet, their loins girded and their staff in hand, left Egypt in haste and began their journey into the wilderness.

1.27. How the Passover foreshadows Jesus Christ's atonement

Exodus 12:3,5,46 ; John 1:29 ; Luke 22:15 ; 1 Peter 1:18-19

1. During Passover, a lamb without blemish was sacrificed. The lamb symbolized Jesus Christ, who is often referred to as the '*Lamb of God*' in the New Testament.
2. Just as the lamb's blood saved the Israelites from death, Jesus' sacrifice is believed to save humanity from sin and spiritual death.
3. The Israelites ate bitter herbs to remind them of their suffering in Egypt. This is seen as a symbol of the bitterness of sin and the suffering Jesus endured during His crucifixion.
4. The Israelites marked their doorposts with the lamb's blood to be spared from the final plague. This act anticipates the blood of Christ, which Christians believe protects and redeems them from eternal death.
5. The unleavened bread eaten during Passover represents purity and the haste of the Israelites' departure from Egypt. In the Last Supper, Jesus used unleavened bread to symbolise His body, establishing the practice of Holy Communion for Christian believers.

1.28. Challenges the Israelites faced while in the desert

1. Lack of water - At several points in the desert, the Israelites had no access to clean drinking water. For example, at Marah, the water was bitter and undrinkable until God made it sweet

(Exodus 15:22-25). In Rephidim, they again faced thirst, leading to complaints against Moses (Exodus 17:1-7).

2. Lack of food - In the wilderness of Sin, the people grumbled about hunger, remembering the food they had in Egypt. God responded by providing manna in the morning and quail in the evening (Exodus 16:1-36).
3. Harsh environmental conditions - The desert was a harsh and barren land with extreme heat during the day and cold at night. These conditions made travel and settlement difficult, especially for such a large group.
4. Hostile attacks from other nations - The Israelites faced opposition from other tribes and nations. For example, the Amalekites attacked them at Rephidim, but they were defeated through God's help and Moses' intercession (Exodus 17:8-16).
5. Lack of faith and rebellion - The Israelites frequently doubted God's power and promises. They complained, rebelled against leadership, and longed to return to Egypt (Numbers 14:1-4). Their lack of faith led to delays and consequences in their journey.
6. Idolatry - While Moses was on Mount Sinai, the people built and worshipped a golden calf, breaking their covenant with God (Exodus 32:1-35). This act brought God's anger and punishment upon them.
7. Internal conflicts and leadership challenges - There were several instances of rebellion and complaints against Moses and Aaron. Examples include the rebellion of Korah and the complaints of Miriam and Aaron (Numbers 12; 16).
8. Fear of the inhabitants of Canaan - When the spies returned from scouting the Promised Land, most of them gave a fearful report, leading the people to doubt God's promise and refuse to enter the land. As a result, they were condemned to wander for 40 years (Numbers 13-14).

1.29. How God cared for the Israelites during the Exodus

Exodus 14:5-31 ; Exodus 15:24-27; Exodus 17:1-6 ; Exodus 16:1-35 ; Exodus 17:8-16

- During the Exodus, God provided for the Israelites in miraculous ways, showing His love, power and faithfulness.
- Through these miracles, God showed His constant care, protection and provision for His people during their journey to the Promised Land.
 - a) God led the Israelites with a pillar of cloud by day and a pillar of fire by night, ensuring they were guided and protected throughout their journey.
 - b) God enabled the Israelites to cross the Red Sea, allowing them to escape from Pharaoh's army by parting the waters and closing them over their enemies.
 - c) When the Israelites were thirsty, God provided water. He made the bitter waters of Marah sweet and brought water out of a rock at Rephidim through Moses.
 - d) When the Israelites complained of hunger, God sent manna from heaven every morning and provided quails in the evening, ensuring they had enough food to sustain them in the wilderness.
 - e) When the Amalekites attacked the Israelites, God gave them victory. As long as Moses raised his hands in prayer, they prevailed. Aaron and Hur supported Moses' hands, leading to their triumph over the enemy.

1.30. THE SINAI COVENANT

A covenant is a binding agreement between two people or groups who were previously separated or distant from each other.

1.31. Making the Sinai covenant

Exodus 19 ; Exodus 24:1-8

- It was during the Exodus that God made a covenant with the Israelites. This covenant is known as the Sinai Covenant because it took place at Mount Sinai. God initiated the covenant because He desired a personal relationship with the Israelites.
- The Israelites promised to obey all that the Lord had said. God gave Moses specific instructions on how the people were to prepare themselves for the making of the covenant.
- God then appeared on Mount Sinai in a dramatic display of thunder, lightning, earthquake, a loud trumpet blast, thick cloud, fire and smoke.
- This covenant was important to the Israelites because:
 - o It confirmed that Israel was God's chosen nation.
 - o It showed that God remembers and fulfils His promises.
 - o Through the making of the covenant, the Israelites learned many qualities of God, such as His holiness, justice, and mercy.
- Moses prepared a ceremony to seal God's covenant with the Israelites:
 - o He built an altar with twelve stones, representing the twelve tribes of Israel.
 - o Young men offered burnt offerings and peace offerings of oxen to the Lord.
 - o Moses took half of the blood and sprinkled it on the altar.
 - o He then read the Book of the Covenant to the people, and they responded by agreeing to obey all that the Lord had commanded.
 - o Moses then sprinkled the remaining blood on the people, saying, 'Behold the blood of the covenant which the Lord has made with you in accordance with all these words.'

1.32. The Ten Commandments

Exodus 20:1-17

- The Ten Commandments are also known as the decalogue. They are part of the laws that God gave to Moses on Mount Sinai.
- These commandments form the foundation of God's covenant with the Israelites and guide how people should relate to God and one another.
 1. You shall have no other gods before Me.
 2. You shall not make for yourself a graven image.
 3. You shall not take the name of the Lord your God in vain.
 4. Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy.
 5. Honour your father and your mother, that your days may be long in the land which the Lord your God gives you.
 6. You shall not kill.
 7. You shall not commit adultery.

8. You shall not steal.
9. You shall not bear false witness against your neighbour.
10. You shall not covet your neighbour's property.

1.33. Applying the Ten Commandments in daily life

1. You shall have no other gods before Me - Put God first in all decisions and trust Him above anything else. Avoid idolizing material things, fame or people.
2. You shall not make for yourself a graven image - Worship God in spirit and truth, not through objects or superstitions. Reject modern-day idols like money, status or social media influence.
3. You shall not take the name of the Lord your God in vain - Speak God's name with respect and reverence. Avoid using God's name carelessly or in anger.
4. Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy. - Set aside one day a week for rest, worship and reflection. Attend church and spend time with family and God.
5. Honour your father and your mother. - Show respect and gratitude to parents and guardians. Obey and care for them, especially in their time of need.
6. You shall not kill. - Respect all human life. Promote peace, avoid violence and resolve conflicts calmly.
7. You shall not commit adultery. - Remain faithful in relationships. Respect the sanctity of marriage and practice purity.
8. You shall not steal. - Be honest in all dealings. Respect other people's property and work hard for your own.
9. You shall not bear false witness against your neighbour. - Always tell the truth. Avoid gossip, slander and false accusations.
10. You shall not covet your neighbour's property. - Be content with what you have. Celebrate others' success without jealousy and avoid greed.

1.34. The breaking of the Sinai Covenant

Exodus 32

- While Moses was on Mount Sinai receiving God's laws, he left Aaron in charge of the Israelites. Moses delayed in returning and the people became impatient
- They asked Aaron to make them a god to lead them. Instead of remaining faithful, Aaron gave in to their pressure.
- He instructed them to bring their gold jewellery, which he then melted to form a golden calf. He built an altar before it and declared the next day a festival of worship.
- The people offered sacrifices and began celebrating, committing idolatry by breaking the first two commandments—worshipping another god and making a graven image.
- God was greatly angered and declared that He would destroy the Israelites. However, Moses interceded on their behalf, pleading with God to forgive them. God relented but remained displeased.
- When Moses descended from the mountain and saw the idol worship, he became furious and smashed the stone tablets containing the Ten Commandments.

- He burned the golden calf, ground it to powder, mixed it with water, and made the people drink it.
- Moses confronted Aaron, who tried to shift the blame. Moses then commanded the Levites, who had remained loyal to God, to execute those who had participated in the idol worship. Around 3,000 people died that day. The Levites were set apart as priests for their loyalty.
- The next day, Moses again went up the mountain to ask for God's forgiveness for the people. God forgave them but sent a plague as punishment.
- Finally, God instructed the Israelites to leave Sinai and continue their journey to the Promised Land.

1.35. Reasons why the Israelites broke the covenant

1. Delayed return of Moses - Moses, their leader, took too long to return from Mount Sinai. The people grew impatient and felt abandoned.
2. Lack of faith in God - The Israelites showed a lack of trust in the God who had delivered them from Egypt.
3. Weak leadership from Aaron - Aaron, who had been left in charge, lacked firmness and gave in to the demands of the people.
4. Desire for a visible God - The people wanted a god they could see and touch. They lacked faith in an invisible God and turned to idol worship.
5. Forgetfulness of God's commands - They had forgotten the teachings Moses had given them regarding their unique relationship with God.
6. Influence of Egyptian religion - Having lived in Egypt for a long time, the Israelites were still influenced by pagan worship practices including the worship of idols and animal figures.

1.36. Renewal of the Sinai Covenant

Exodus 34:1-35

- The renewal of the Sinai Covenant took place after Moses pleaded with God not to destroy the Israelites following their disobedience.
- God spared the Israelites and instructed Moses to cut two new stone tablets so that the commandments could be rewritten.
- During the renewal, the Israelites learned important attributes of God – that He is merciful, gracious, jealous, slow to anger, loving, faithful and forgiving.
- God chose to renew the covenant because He remembered the promises He had made to their ancestor Abraham.
- Through Moses, God gave the Israelites new conditions for the renewal of the covenant. These conditions included:
 - o Obey all of God's commandments.
 - o Offer to God the first fruits of their harvest.
 - o Not make any covenant with the people living in the land of Canaan.
 - o Destroy all places of idol worship found in the land of Canaan.
 - o Worship no other god but Yahweh.
 - o Keep the Feast of Unleavened Bread.

- Dedicate all first-born male children and animals to God.
- Not intermarry with foreigners.
- Not make idols to represent God.
- Rest on the seventh day (observe the Sabbath).
- After giving these commands, God made a promise to the Israelites:
 - He would protect and preserve them.
 - He would bless them and make them prosper.
- Finally, God instructed Moses to write down all these words on a new set of stone tablets. This act sealed the renewal of the covenant between God and the Israelites.

1.37. How the Israelites worshipped God in the wilderness

Exodus 20:22-26 ; Exodus 20:24-25 ; Exodus 23:14-20 ; Exodus 26

- Worship refers to the means of communicating with God and honouring Him as the Creator and Controller of the universe. We worship God because we realise our limitations and depend on Him.
- The Israelites worshipped God as a way of acknowledging and recognizing His supremacy. Their worship involved prayers, petitions for desired things and thanksgiving for protection and providence.
- Singing praise songs was also part of their worship. Through the different forms of worship, the Israelites understood who Yahweh was and developed a close relationship with Him.
- The Israelites worshipped God through:
 - a) Feasts:

These were celebrations conducted to commemorate significant events. Some of the festivals included:

 - The Passover feast
 - The Feast of unleavened bread
 - The Feast of weeks
 - The Feast of tabernacles
 - b) Sacrifices and offerings:

Animals were used in sacrifices, while agricultural produce was given as offerings.
 - c) The tabernacle:

This was a portable structure where the Israelites worshipped God. It symbolised the presence of God among His people. The tabernacle was also referred to as the tent of meeting.
 - d) The Ark of the covenant:

This sacred chest was placed in the inner court (Holy of Holies). It contained the two stone tablets on which the Ten Commandments were written.

1.38. Ways in which Christians worship God

- By praying
- By singing hymns and worship songs
- By reading and studying the Bible

- By celebrating the sacraments (Holy Communion and Baptism)
- By attending church services
- By offering and tithing
- By serving others
- By obeying God's commands

1.39. LOYALTY TO GOD (ELIJAH)

Forms of idol worship and religious extremism in today's society

1. Some religious cults encourage the separation of family members and friends, telling people not to go to hospitals or attend school. In some cults, followers are even told to fast or starve to death.
2. Some people value wealth and popularity more than God, treating celebrities like gods, emulating everything they do, and placing their trust in charms, statues or lucky items for protection or success instead of having faith in God.
3. People believing that their religion is the only true one and looking down on others who follow different beliefs.
4. Forcing people to follow strict religious rules without giving them a choice.
5. Fighting or discriminating against others because of their religion.
6. The influence of radicalization through social media—being misled by extreme ideologies online and rejecting normal societal values.
7. Manipulation by religious or political leaders who convince people to adopt dangerous beliefs. Some radicalized individuals may even harm others in the name of religion or ideology.
8. Using religion for personal gain—some leaders exploit their followers financially or emotionally under the guise of spiritual authority.
9. Blindly following traditions or rituals without understanding their meaning, leading to superstition and fear-based worship instead of genuine faith.

1.40. Ways of discerning idol worship and devil worship as a christian

1 Timothy 4:1-4 ; James 2:14-21 ; Mathew 7:15-20

1. By studying the Scriptures regularly to understand God's truth and recognize teachings that go against His word.
2. By praying for spiritual discernment so that God can guide you in identifying false beliefs and ungodly practices.
3. By testing every teaching or practice against the Bible to ensure it aligns with God's truth.
4. By observing the behavior and character (fruits) of a group or leader to see if they reflect the love, humility and truth of Christ.
5. By seeking advice and counsel from mature Christians or trusted church leaders when you're unsure about a group or teaching.
6. By avoiding any group that encourages isolation from family, secrecy or cutting ties with your community or church.

7. By staying away from groups that deny Jesus Christ as Lord and Savior or reject the core message of the Gospel.
8. By being cautious of practices involving charms, rituals or symbols that distract from faith in the one true God.
9. By rejecting any group or teaching that uses fear, threats or force to control people's beliefs or actions.
10. By trusting the conviction of the Holy Spirit, who gives believers a sense of peace or warning when something is spiritually wrong.

1.41. Elijah fights against Baalism in Israel

1 Kings 18

- Elijah was instructed by God to present himself to King Ahab in the third year of a severe drought in Samaria. When King Ahab saw Elijah, he called him "*the troubler of Israel*." Elijah responded by saying that it was actually King Ahab and his family who had brought trouble upon Israel by disobeying God and worshipping Baal.
- Elijah then requested King Ahab to summon all the prophets of Baal and the Israelites to Mount Carmel. Ahab agreed and gathered them as Elijah had asked. When the people assembled, Elijah confronted the Israelites, asking them how long they would waver between two opinions. He challenged them to make a clear decision—either to worship the Lord or to worship Baal.
- To prove who the true God was, Elijah proposed a contest. He asked for two bulls—one to be offered by the prophets of Baal and the other by himself. Each group was to prepare a sacrifice without setting fire to it. The God who answered by sending fire to consume the sacrifice would be acknowledged as the true God.
- Elijah allowed the prophets of Baal to go first. They prepared their bull and called on the name of Baal from morning until noon. They shouted, danced, and even cut themselves with swords, but there was no response—no fire came. Elijah mocked them, suggesting that perhaps their god was asleep or on a journey.
- When it was Elijah's turn, he called the people to gather around him. He repaired the altar of the Lord using twelve stones, representing the twelve tribes of Israel. He dug a trench around the altar, arranged the wood, and placed the sacrifice on it. Then, he instructed the people to pour water over the sacrifice and the wood until the trench was filled with water.
- Elijah then prayed to the God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, asking Him to reveal Himself as the true God of Israel. Immediately, fire from heaven fell and consumed the sacrifice, the wood, the stones, the soil, and even the water in the trench.
- When the people witnessed this miracle, they fell face down and declared, "*The Lord—He is God! The Lord—He is God!*" Elijah then commanded them to seize all the prophets of Baal, and they were taken to the brook of Kishon, where Elijah put them to death.
- This dramatic event is known as the **Contest on Mount Carmel** and it marked a powerful confrontation between true worship of God and the false worship of Baal.

1.42. Analyzing Elijah's fight against Baalism

- Elijah was the only known true prophet of God in Israel at that time. Many other prophets of the Lord had been killed by the orders of Queen Jezebel, while others had gone into hiding for their safety.
- King Ahab, influenced by Queen Jezebel, actively promoted the worship of Baal. This practice of worshipping Baal and other idols was known as Baalism.
- Baalism is the worship of false gods or idols, and it had become widespread in Israel because it was officially supported by the king and queen.
- Elijah organized the contest on Mount Carmel mainly to prove to the Israelites that there is only one true God who answers prayers.
- The contest was between Elijah, representing Yahweh (the God of Israel), and the prophets of Baal.
- During the Mount Carmel contest, the Israelites witnessed the power and truth of Yahweh. From this event, they learned the following about the nature of God:
 - Yahweh is the only true God - Baal failed to answer, but Yahweh responded with fire from heaven.
 - Yahweh is a God of justice - He judged the false prophets of Baal for leading the people astray.
 - Yahweh answers prayers - Elijah's prayer was answered immediately with fire from heaven.
 - Yahweh is a merciful God - He gave the Israelites a chance to turn back to Him.
 - Yahweh is a jealous God - He does not tolerate the worship of other gods.
 - God is powerful and mighty - His fire consumed the sacrifice, the stones, the soil and the water.

1.43. Circumstances surrounding Elijah's flight to Mount Horeb**1 Kings 19**

- After the contest on Mount Carmel, King Ahab returned home and told Queen Jezebel about Elijah's challenge and how Elijah had killed all the prophets of Baal. Jezebel was furious and vowed to kill Elijah by the next day.
- Fearful for his life, Elijah fled with his servant to Beersheba in Judah. There, he left his servant and went alone into the wilderness. Exhausted and discouraged, Elijah prayed to God to take his life and fell asleep under a tree.
- While he was resting, an angel appeared and provided him with food—bread and water—which gave him the strength to continue. Elijah then traveled for forty days and forty nights until he reached Mount Horeb, where he hid in a cave.
- Though still afraid, God called to Elijah and asked why he was there. Elijah expressed his fear and loneliness.
- God then instructed Elijah to stand on the mountain, where Elijah experienced powerful natural phenomena: a strong wind, an earthquake, and a fire.
- However, God was not present in any of these events. Instead, Elijah heard a still, small voice. When Elijah heard the gentle whisper, he covered his face, afraid to look upon God. God again asked Elijah why he was there.

- Following this encounter, God gave Elijah new instructions to return to the wilderness to anoint new kings for Syria and Israel and to anoint Elisha as his successor.
- Elisha then followed Elijah and served as his helper.

1.44. Elijah's fight against injustices in Israel

1 Kings 21

- Naboth owned a vineyard in Jezreel that was next to King Ahab's palace. King Ahab wanted to acquire the vineyard so he could use it to grow vegetables.
- He approached Naboth and offered to exchange or buy the vineyard, but Naboth refused to sell or exchange it because it was ancestral land; land that belonged to his family and was meant to be kept within the family.
- King Ahab returned home looking very sad and even refused to eat. He explained the situation to his wife, Queen Jezebel.
- Jezebel challenged Ahab, asking if he was the king of Israel and assuring him that she could help him get the vineyard.
- Jezebel then wrote letters in King Ahab's name to the elders and nobles of the city, instructing them to accuse Naboth of cursing God (blasphemy) and the king (treason).
- The elders brought false witnesses who testified against Naboth and as a result, Naboth was taken outside the city and stoned to death.
- When Jezebel received news of Naboth's death, she told King Ahab to go and take possession of the vineyard.
- However, God sent the prophet Elijah to pronounce judgment on King Ahab and his family for breaking God's covenant.
- When Ahab heard the judgment spoken through Elijah, he showed remorse by wearing sackcloth as a sign of repentance. Because of his repentance, God delayed the punishment until the reign of Ahab's son.
- The injustices committed against Naboth are:
 - o Naboth was stoned to death, violating his right to life.
 - o His vineyard, his ancestral land, was taken from him unlawfully.
 - o False evidence was used to condemn him.
 - o Naboth was not given a chance to defend himself against the accusations of blasphemy and treason.

1.45. Values and life skills needed to address social injustices in the society today

- Values are standards that guide how we think and act. They help us decide what is right and what is wrong.
- Some important values that help us address social injustices include:
 - a) Honesty - Being truthful and transparent in actions and speech.
 - b) Love - Showing genuine care and concern for others.
 - c) Respect - Valuing the dignity and rights of every individual.
 - d) Humility - Being modest and open to learning from others.
 - e) Empathy - Understanding and sharing the feelings of others.

- f) Responsibility - Taking ownership of one's actions and their consequences.
- g) Justice - Standing for fairness and equality for all.
- h) Courage - Being brave enough to stand up against injustice.
- Life skills are abilities that enable individuals to deal effectively with the demands and challenges of everyday life. They help us make informed decisions and avoid risky behaviors.
- Key life skills needed to address social injustices include:
 - a) Critical thinking - Analyzing situations carefully before making decisions.
 - b) Creative thinking - Finding innovative solutions to problems.
 - c) Assertiveness - Expressing your views confidently and respectfully.
 - d) Decision making - Choosing the best course of action after evaluating options.
 - e) Self-control - Managing emotions and impulses in difficult situations.
 - f) Effective communication - Sharing ideas clearly and listening to others.
 - g) Problem-solving - Identifying problems and working toward practical solutions.
 - h) Collaboration - Working well with others to achieve common goals.

1.46. THE OLD TESTAMENT PROPHETS

- **Prophets** are people chosen by God to receive His messages. They guide, warn or teach others based on what God reveals to them.
- A prophet is also someone who foretells future events as revealed by God.
- **Prophecy** is the message given by a prophet. It can concern the future, God's will or important teachings about what is going to happen.

1.47. Categories of Old Testament prophets

1. Major prophets - These prophets have long, detailed and elaborate messages. They include: Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel and Daniel.
2. Minor prophets - These prophets deliver shorter or briefer messages. There are twelve minor prophets: Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah and Malachi.
3. Canonical prophets - These are the law prophets whose messages are recorded in individual books named after them. Both major and minor prophets fall under this category. Examples include Isaiah, Ezekiel and Nahum.
4. Non-canonical prophets - These prophets' messages are not recorded in books bearing their names but are compiled by other authors. Examples include Nathan, Elisha, Elijah, Moses and Gad.

1.48. Importance of prophets in Israel

- They acted as mediators between God and the people.
- They guided and counseled the people.
- They foretold future events.
- Some prophets also acted as priests and carried out religious functions.
- They warned people of God's impending judgment for sin.

- They gave messages of hope to the people.
- They condemned idolatry.
- They called people to repentance and moral living.
- They upheld God's covenant and reminded the people of their responsibilities.
- They encouraged social justice by speaking out against oppression and injustice.

1.49. Relationship between Old and New Testament prophecies

- The Old Testament contains numerous prophecies that are fulfilled through Jesus Christ in the New Testament. The New Testament explains how Jesus' life, death and resurrection complete these prophecies, presenting Him as the promised Messiah.
- The teachings of Jesus in the New Testament are based on Old Testament prophecies. Stories and lessons such as that of Moses, are referenced and fulfilled in both Testaments.
- Specific prophecies given to the Old Testament prophets, like Nathan's promise to King David about a descendant who would establish an everlasting dynasty, are fulfilled in Jesus Christ, affirming His role as the Messiah.
- Prophecies such as Isaiah's prediction of a virgin birth (Isaiah 7:14) are fulfilled and confirmed in the New Testament, demonstrating continuity and divine planning across both Testaments.
- The suffering servant described in Isaiah 53 is fulfilled in the life, suffering, and death of Jesus Christ, showing how Old Testament prophecies reveal the nature of the Messiah's mission.
- The outpouring of the Holy Spirit, predicted by the prophet Joel (Joel 2:28), is fulfilled during Pentecost in the New Testament when the Holy Spirit descended upon the disciples, marking the beginning of the Church.
- The New Testament often references Old Testament prophecies to validate Jesus' identity and mission, helping believers understand that Jesus is the fulfillment of God's long-awaited promises.

1.50. Characteristics of true prophets

Jeremiah 28:9, Deuteronomy 18:18

- True prophets of God are humble, speak the truth and lead a Christ-like life.
- They produce godly fruits in their character and actions.
- They fearlessly speak out against injustice.
- They preach righteousness and holiness, revealing the outcomes of people's lives based on their obedience or disobedience to God.
- They spend a lot of time in prayer and communion with God.
- Their messages sharpen and encourage people to do the will of God and provide divine direction.
- Their prophecies edify, correct, reprove, and guide people towards fulfilling God's purpose.
- They understand God's nature and teach about righteousness, goodness, mercy and love for others.

1.51. Characteristics of false prophets

Jeremiah 14:14, Deuteronomy 18:21-22, Mathew 7:15

- They have no personal knowledge of God.
- Their predictions do not come to pass.
- They teach doctrines that differ from the teachings of Christ.
- They deny the authority and lordship of Jesus Christ.
- They make false religious claims.
- They use tricks or manipulations to attract followers.
- They are dishonest about their true intentions.
- They try to create divisions within congregations.
- They ignore or dismiss the need for repentance.
- They reinterpret scriptures to support their own views.
- They demand payments or offerings for their services.
- They act as poor role models within the community.

1.52. Relevance of prophecy to Christians today

It helps Christians understand God's will and make wise decisions.

Fulfilled prophecies demonstrate God's power and build trust in His promises.

It reminds Christians to live righteously and avoid wrongdoing.

It provides hope and assurance, especially during difficult times.

Prophecy reveals God's plan for the end times and the return of Christ.

It encourages deeper study of the Bible and fosters a closer relationship with God.

Christians are reminded to be ready and willing to serve as messengers of God.

1.53. BACKGROUND OF PROPHET AMOS

1.54. Background to the call of prophet Amos

- Amos is one of the prophets God sent to Israel to warn the people against their evil ways. Amos was a native of Tekoa, which was south of Jerusalem.
- He was a shepherd and also grew sycamore trees. He was also in charge of other shepherds. He preached mainly from Bethel, condemning the social and religious sins of Israel.
- He was from the Southern Kingdom (Judah) but was called to prophesy to the Northern Kingdom (Israel).
- Although he was called by God from his work to prophesy to the people of the Northern Kingdom (Israel), he still had a message for the people of Judah, showing that God was universal.
- Politically, the nation of Israel had become rich. Social classes had developed—the rich and the poor. The rich began oppressing the poor.
- Socially, the rich exploited the poor. Merchants sold bad food at high prices and used false scales.
- Religiously, the Israelites had turned away from God and were worshipping false gods. Syncretism was practiced.
- Priests were paid and God's prophets were rejected. It was in this situation that Amos was called.

1.55. The call of prophet Amos

Amos 1:1 ; Amos 3:8 ; Amos 7:10-15

- Amos was a shepherd from a village called Tekoa in Judah, located near Jerusalem. He was called by God during the reign of King Uzziah of Judah and King Jeroboam II of Israel.
- God called Amos through a vision. He felt obligated to prophesy and did not resist or make excuses.
- He responded to God's call with faith and obedience, leaving his work as a shepherd. He mainly prophesied in Bethel, which was the center of worship for the people of Israel.
- Amos delivered a message of judgment against Israel. He prophesied that Jeroboam would die by the sword and that the people of Israel would be taken into exile.
- This message of punishment greatly angered Amaziah, the priest at Bethel, who ordered Amos to flee to Judah and prophesy there instead.
- Amos defended himself by saying that he was not a professional prophet, but that it was God who had sent him to prophesy.

1.56. Lessons learnt from the call of Amos

- Christians should obey God's call to serve Him.
- One does not need to be a religious leader in order to serve God.
- The work of God goes beyond tribal or national boundaries. We should be ready to serve anywhere as directed by God.
- God can use anyone, regardless of their social status, to carry out His work. He used Amos, who was a mere shepherd.
- Christians should promote social justice.
- We should be sincere in worship and avoid hypocrisy.
- Christians should be prepared to face opposition as they carry out their duties.

1.57. Visions of Prophet Amos and their significance

Amos 7:1-3 ; Amos 7:4-6 ; Amos 7:7-9 ; Amos 8:1-3 ; Amos 9:1-4

1. The vision of locusts (Amos 7:1-3)

- Amos saw God sending a great swarm of locusts about to consume all the plants in Israel.
- This vision symbolized the disaster that God intended to bring upon Israel as punishment for their sins.
- Amos pleaded with God to forgive the people and God listened to his prayer and withdrew the punishment.

2. The vision of fire (Amos 7:4-6)

- Amos saw a supernatural fire that was burning up the land, threatening to destroy everything.
- Once again, Amos interceded on behalf of the people, asking God to forgive them.
- God heard his plea and stopped the punishment.

3. The vision of the plumb line (Amos 7:7-9)

- Amos saw the Lord standing by a wall that had been built with a plumb line.

- God was now using the plumb line to measure how straight the wall still stood.
- The crooked wall represented the people of Israel, who had deviated from God's laws and covenant.
- Because of their corruption, God declared that He would destroy the high places and sanctuaries of Israel.
- This time, Amos remained silent, indicating that judgment was now certain.

4. The vision of a basket of ripe fruit (Amos 8:1-3)

- Amos saw a basket of ripe fruits.
- This vision signified that the Israelites were 'ripe' for judgment—the time for repentance had passed.
- Just as a farmer must harvest ripe fruit without delay, God would no longer postpone His punishment.
- Amos did not intercede in this vision, as God's decision was final.

5. The vision of the destruction of the altar (Amos 9:1-4)

- Amos saw God standing by the altar, commanding its destruction beginning with the pillars.
- The altar had become a center of idolatry and evil practices.
- The vision showed worshippers being struck down, crushed by the falling debris.
- God declared that no sinner would escape—He would pursue and destroy the wicked, no matter where they tried to hide.
- His judgment was inescapable.

1.58. Relevance of Prophet Amos' visions to Christians today

1. Christians learn that God can use visions to reveal His will concerning the world and the Church.
2. They are reminded to respect places of worship, as they are meant for holy purposes.
3. Christians should repent of their sins to avoid God's judgment.
4. They learn that God punishes sin and does not tolerate disobedience.
5. Christians understand that no one can escape God's punishment—He sees and knows all.
6. They are encouraged to pray, knowing that God listens. God withdrew punishment on two occasions when Amos interceded.
7. Christians are taught to obey the word of God faithfully.

1.59. Evils and injustices that can bring judgment to a nation

- a) Corruption in leadership - When leaders misuse power for personal gain or oppress their citizens.
- b) Oppression of the poor and vulnerable - Exploiting or neglecting the needs of the needy in society.
- c) Dishonest business practices - Using false weights and measures, overpricing goods or selling harmful products.
- d) Religious hypocrisy - Engaging in outward acts of worship while living in sin and ignoring God's commands.
- e) Idolatry and false worship - Turning away from the true God to worship idols or practice syncretism.

- f) Injustice in the legal system - Taking bribes, denying justice to the poor or favoring the rich in courts.
- g) Moral decay - Promoting immorality such as sexual sin, violence and substance abuse.
- h) Failure to repent - Ignoring warnings from God and refusing to change sinful behavior.
- i) Violence and bloodshed - Allowing or encouraging violence including political or tribal conflict.
- j) Exploitation of workers - Underpaying workers or exposing them to poor working conditions.

1.60. Practising justice as guided by the teachings of Prophet Amos

- By treating all people fairly and without discrimination.
- By being honest in business dealings and avoiding cheating.
- By speaking out against corruption and injustice in society.
- By defending and supporting the poor, widows, orphans and the oppressed.
- By refusing to give or receive bribes in any form.
- By worshiping God with sincerity and avoiding hypocrisy.
- By promoting fairness and equality in the legal system.
- By paying workers fair wages for their labor.
- By obeying God's commandments in everyday life.
- By encouraging peace and unity among all people.

1.61. Prophet Amos' teachings and their relevance to Christians today

a) Amos 2:6-8

Teaching:

Amos denounced Israel for exploiting the poor and selling them into slavery for small debts. Judges and leaders accepted bribes, allowing injustice to flourish. The rich engaged in sexual immorality and dishonored sacred places.

Relevance to Christians today:

- Christians are reminded to uphold justice and protect the vulnerable.
- They should not value wealth over human dignity.
- Leaders must resist corruption and serve with integrity.
- Christians must lead morally upright lives, avoiding sexual sin and respecting sacred spaces.

b) Amos 3:9-12

Teaching:

Amos called on foreign nations to witness the oppression and corruption in Israel. He warned that due to their sins, destruction would come and only a small remnant would survive—like a shepherd saving only parts of a sheep from a lion's mouth.

Relevance to Christians today:

- Christians are reminded that sin, especially oppression, invites God's judgment.
- Nations and individuals must be accountable for how they treat others.
- Even in judgment, God may preserve a faithful remnant—offering hope through repentance.

c) Amos 4:1-3

Teaching:

Amos condemned the wealthy women of Samaria—calling them "cows of Bashan"—for oppressing

the poor and demanding luxury. He warned they would be taken into captivity for their selfishness.

Relevance to Christians today:

- Christians should avoid greed and materialism.
- Women and men alike are called to compassion, not selfish indulgence.
- Social status or wealth does not protect anyone from God's justice.

d) Amos 5:10-15

Teaching:

Amos criticized leaders for hating those who spoke the truth and for corrupting justice. He urged the people to seek good, love justice and defend the poor so that God might have mercy on them.

Relevance to Christians today:

- Christians must stand for truth, even when it is unpopular.
- They should pursue justice, love what is right and care for the marginalized.
- Mercy from God is tied to how people treat one another, especially the weak.

e) Amos 6:1-8

Teaching:

Amos rebuked the wealthy who lived in luxury while ignoring the suffering of the poor. He warned that their comfort would not protect them from the coming judgment.

Relevance to Christians today:

- Christians must not be complacent or indifferent to the suffering around them.
- Wealth should be used to uplift others, not as a shield for self-indulgence.
- God calls for active compassion and social responsibility.

f) Amos 8:4-6

Teaching:

Amos condemned merchants who cheated the poor using false scales and dishonest practices. He warned that God sees such injustices and will not ignore them.

Relevance to Christians today:

- Christians in business must act with honesty and fairness.
- Exploiting others for profit is a serious sin in God's eyes.
- God values justice in all areas of life including economics.

1.62. Ways of preventing social evils in the society today

- By implementing and enforcing laws against crimes such as corruption, gender-based violence and child labor to deter offenders.
- By obeying the laws of the land and respecting the constitution to help eliminate social evils in society.
- By teaching and promoting values such as respect, equality and tolerance in schools and communities to prevent discrimination and corruption.
- By reporting offenders to the relevant authorities to ensure action is taken and discourage others from committing crimes.
- By creating job opportunities to reduce poverty and empower people to live dignified lives.
- By encouraging community involvement and dialogue to identify and stop social evils early.

- By promoting access to quality education to equip people with knowledge and skills for positive life choices.
- By supporting and empowering vulnerable groups to reduce their exploitation and vulnerability.

1.63. Common cults and ungodly groups in society

- The characteristics of cults and ungodly groups include:
 1. They distort Scripture or introduce teachings that contradict the Bible.
 2. They have one leader or a small group that demands total obedience.
 3. They discourage members from associating with family, friends or other churches.
 4. They use fear, guilt, and pressure to control their members.
 5. They force members to give large amounts of money or property.
 6. They promote rituals or extreme behaviors not found in the Bible.
 7. They deny Jesus as God or teach salvation by works instead of grace.
- You can avoid joining cults or ungodly groups by:
 - studying God's Word to recognize false teachings.
 - praying for discernment and wisdom.
 - joining a Christ-centered church with sound doctrine.
 - being cautious of groups that isolate, manipulate or pressure you.
 - seeking advice from mature Christian leaders or mentors.
 - staying connected with a supportive Christian community.
 - testing all teachings against the Bible before accepting them.

1.64. Prophet Amos teachings on hypocritical religion practiced by the Israelites

Amos 4:4-5; Amos 5:4-5; Amos 5:21-27

- Prophet Amos strongly condemned hypocritical religion. This refers to outward religious practices without genuine faith and obedience to God.
- Amos teaches that religion without righteousness is worthless. True worship must come from the heart, accompanied by justice, love and obedience to God.
- Hypocritical religion leads to judgment and destruction, but genuine faith brings life and blessings.
- In Amos 4:4-5, Amos 5:4-5, and Amos 5:21-27, Amos highlights the following key teachings:
 1. **Amos 4:4-5:** God sarcastically invites Israel to continue their rituals at Bethel and Gilgal, places known for idolatrous worship. They offer sacrifices and tithes but their worship is self-centered and insincere. They take pride in their offerings but fail to live righteously.
 2. **Amos 5:4-5:** God calls Israel to "Seek Him and live," emphasizing a relationship with Him rather than trusting in religious sites such as Bethel, Gilgal and Beersheba. These places had become symbols of idolatry and false security, leading people away from true worship.
 3. **Amos 5:21-27:** God hates Israel's festivals, sacrifices and songs because they are performed without justice and righteousness. Israel secretly worshipped idols while pretending to serve God.

1.65. Prophet Amos' teachings on judgment against Israel and other nations

- Amos 1:3-5: The people of Syria (Damascus) had threshed the people of Gilead with threshing sledges of iron during their war with Israel. God would send fire upon their land to destroy their palaces. The people of Syria would be taken into exile in Kir, where they would serve as slaves.
- Amos 4:1-3: The rich women of Samaria were living in luxury at the expense of the poor. These women would be taken into exile.
- Amos 5:1-17: Punishment against Israel includes:
 1. Earthquakes causing widespread destruction.
 2. Invasion by a foreign nation that could kill many people and destroy the land.
 3. Eclipses, with the land covered in darkness during the day.
 4. Destruction of the altar at Bethel.
 5. Exile: Israel would be taken into exile beyond Damascus.
- Many social evils exist in society today, such as selling unworthy and expired goods to unsuspecting customers.
- We should make an effort to correct these evils to create a fair and just society where peace prevails.
- In modern society, cults, ungodly groups, religious extremism and devil worship also exist. We should be able to identify forms of hypocritical religion and avoid being part of them.

1.66. Interpreting Israel's election with reference to bible texts

Amos 2:9-11, Amos 3:2, Amos 9:7

- Israel's election refers to the act of God choosing the Israelites to fulfill His purpose for the human race.
- God made a covenant with the Israelites on Mount Sinai, making them a holy nation expected to recognize God alone by keeping His commandments.
- Prophet Amos taught the following regarding Israel's election:
 1. The election made Israel God's chosen people, who had an obligation to serve Him alone.
 2. The election was initiated by God out of His love for the Israelites and their forefathers.
 3. Israel's election gave them a special responsibility to serve God.
 4. The Israelites would be punished if they failed in their responsibility to serve God.
 5. God could choose any other nation if Israel failed to serve Him.
 6. The Israelites were delivered from slavery in Egypt because of their election.
 7. God gave them land to possess because of their election.
 8. God protected and led them in the wilderness for forty years because of their election.
 9. God gave them prophets and the law to guide them in their daily living.

1.67. Teachings of 'the Day of the Lord'

Amos 5:18-20, Amos 6:3-5, Amos 8:7-14

- The Day of the Lord is a time of judgment for the wicked, when God's wrath is poured out on them, while His people are delivered or restored.
- Prophet Amos warned that the Day of the Lord will not be a day of blessing for the unjust, but a day of judgment and darkness.

- Amos emphasizes that it will be a day of darkness and disaster specifically for those who are unjust.
- Amos condemns those who live in luxury and ignore the coming judgment. He criticizes leaders who enjoy fine foods, music and wine while neglecting justice and the suffering of others. Such people will be the first to be punished when disaster comes.
- There will be a spiritual famine; not of food or water, but of hearing God's word. People will search for divine guidance but will not find it, indicating that rejecting God leads to spiritual emptiness.
- Prophet Amos delivers a warning about God's impending judgment on Israel due to their corruption, dishonesty and oppression of the poor.

1.68. Interpreting scriptures on the second coming of Christ

Matthew 24:36-44, Matthew 25:1-13, Luke 21:25-28, 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17, Revelation 1:7

Christians believe in the second coming of Christ at the end of time. Christ is expected to return as Lord and Judge.

a) Matthew 24:36-44

- Only God the Father knows the hour and day of the second coming of Christ.
- The second coming will happen at an unexpected time, just like the floods came during Noah's time.
- We should be watchful for the day of the Lord, as no one knows when it will come.
- We should always be ready because Christ will come again at an hour we least expect.

b) Matthew 25:1-13

- The second coming of Christ will occur at an unexpected hour.
- Christ will take only those who are ready for His coming.
- We should remain watchful since neither the day nor the hour is known.

c) Luke 21:25-28

- There will be signs in the sun, moon, stars, and earth during the second coming of Christ. These signs include the roaring of the sea and people fainting from fear.
- Christ will come in a cloud with power and great glory.
- The second coming of Christ is a sign of our redemption.

d) 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17

- Christ will come down from heaven with a commanding cry, the archangel's call, and the sound of a trumpet.
- At His coming, those who died believing in Him will rise first.
- The living believers will follow to meet Christ and be with Him forever.

e) Revelation 1:7

- Christ will appear from the clouds and will be seen by everyone.
- All who see Him will mourn.

1.69. How Christians should prepare for the second coming of Christ

- The second coming of Christ refers to the day when Jesus Christ is expected to return as Lord and Judge.

- On this day, everyone will give an account of their actions in light of the teachings of Christ.
- Christians should prepare for the second coming of Christ in the following ways:
 - a) By pursuing righteousness.
 - b) By preaching the word of God to win many souls to Christ.
 - c) By fellowshiping with one another.
 - d) By confessing sins regularly.
 - e) By partaking of the Holy Communion.
 - f) By reading the Bible and obeying its teachings.
 - g) By helping the needy such as the sick, orphans, widows and the poor.
 - h) By praying and fasting.

1.70. The meaning of remnant and restoration to the nation of Israel

Amos 9:8-15

- A remnant refers to a small number that survives destruction. In the Bible, the term *remnant* is used by prophets to describe a small group of faithful Israelites who survive God's punishment.
- Restoration refers to the action of returning something to its former place, owner, or condition. In the Bible, restoration means improving something or returning it to its original state. God promised to restore the Israelites back to their land after exile.
- The remnant refers to the Israelites who sincerely repent and turn to God. He would restore them back to their land and preserve them.
- The teachings of Prophet Amos on the remnant and restoration give Christians hope that only the unrepentant will perish.
- Christians have a moral responsibility to live holy lives to avoid destruction.
 1. God declared that He would destroy the sinful kingdom of Israel because of their disobedience. However, He promised not to completely destroy the house of Jacob but would preserve a faithful remnant. He will separate the righteous from the wicked. The sinners who think they are safe from judgment will perish by the sword.
 2. God promises to rebuild the fallen tent of David, symbolizing the restoration of Israel's leadership and unity. This prophecy foreshadows the Messianic kingdom, where Israel will once again prosper and rule over the nations.
 3. God describes abundant harvests, where planting and reaping will happen simultaneously, symbolizing great prosperity. The people of Israel will return to their land, rebuild cities and enjoy security.
 4. The restoration will be permanent, and Israel will never be uprooted again.

1.71. Applying values acquired from the teachings of Prophet Amos in daily life

- a) Obedience - Following God's commands and living according to His will.
- b) Integrity - Being honest and consistent in words and actions.
- c) Responsibility - Taking ownership of one's duties and caring for others.
- d) Faithfulness - Remaining loyal to God and trustworthy in relationships.
- e) Hope - Trusting in God's promises even during difficult times.
- f) Fairness - Treating others justly without favoritism or discrimination.

- g) Love - Showing kindness, compassion and care for others.
- h) Righteousness - Living a life that reflects God's standards of right and justice.

2. THE NEW TESTAMENT

2.1. THE NEW TESTAMENT BOOKS

2.2. New Testament books

The New Testament contains 27 books, which are subdivided into four major categories.

a) **The Gospels:**

These books record the good news of salvation for humankind through Jesus Christ. The books include *Matthew*, *Mark*, *Luke* and *John*.

b) **Historical book:**

This category contains only one book – *The Acts of the Apostles*. It deals with the history of the early Church.

c) **The Epistles or Letters:**

There are 21 letters written by different authors and addressed to the early Church. They are categorized into:

i. **The letters of Paul (Pauline Epistles):**

- *Romans*
- *1 Corinthians*
- *2 Corinthians*
- *Galatians*
- *Ephesians*
- *Philippians*
- *Colossians*
- *1 Thessalonians*
- *2 Thessalonians*
- *1 Timothy*
- *2 Timothy*
- *Titus*
- *Philemon*

ii. **General letters:**

- *Hebrews*
- *James*
- *1 Peter*
- *2 Peter*
- *1 John*
- *2 John*
- *3 John*
- *Jude*

d) **Prophetic Book:**

This is the last book in the New Testament – *Revelation*. It talks about God's will for the future and is also called the *Apocalypse*.

2.3. Why the bible is referred to as a library

- The Holy Bible is one book, although it contains many books that were written by different people at different times.
- The Bible is referred to as a **library** because:
 - It was written for different audiences and for different reasons.
 - It is a collection of many books.
 - It was written by different people.
 - It was written at different times.
 - It is arranged categorically.
 - It contains different messages.
 - It has different divisions.
 - The books are written in different literary forms.

2.4. Areas and places where the bible is used in Kenya today

- In the courts of law.
- In schools and colleges.
- In State House/during state functions.
- In churches.
- During crusades.
- At home for personal use.
- In Parliament.
- In hospitals.

2.5. Ways in which Christians use the bible to spread the gospel

- Used in instructing new converts.
- Used during preaching and teaching by priests and pastors.
- Used in the teaching of Christian Religious Education (C.R.E.) in schools and colleges.
- Used as a reference book in disseminating information or in the search for knowledge.
- Used in writing Christian songs and hymns.
- Used in administering oaths.
- Used in writing Christian literature.
- Read aloud to fellow Christians.

2.6. Reasons why Christians use the bible in worship

- It is the Word of God.
- It helps them identify with God and Jesus and enhances their unity.
- To recite prayers from it such as the Lord's Prayer.
- It provides guidelines and rituals such as the Lord's Supper and marriage.
- It is a source of belief about God, Jesus, the Holy Spirit and the Church.
- It outlines church leadership; the roles of pastors, evangelists and deacons.

- It is a source of Christian customs, e.g., giving offerings, dedication of children and celebration of the Eucharist.
- It is a source of miracles, healing and other blessings.
- To strengthen their faith and hope in God.

2.7. Reasons why Christians find it difficult to read the bible

- Lack of discipline and commitment to read the Bible.
- Being too busy with work.
- The availability of other forms of entertainment such as movies that take up most of people's time or worldly pleasures.
- Many people don't see the importance of reading the Bible frequently.
- People find it difficult to understand the Bible.
- Some churches don't provide guidelines on how to read the Bible.
- Many people believe that pastors and church leaders are the only ones who are supposed to read the Bible.
- Some people are semi-illiterate.
- Some people don't have the scriptures in a language they understand.

2.8. THE INFANCY AND EARLY LIFE OF JESUS CHRIST

2.9. Old Testament prophecies about the Messiah

- *Messiah* is a Hebrew word which means 'anointed.'
- *Prophecy* is a prediction of what will happen in the future.
- *Messianic prophecies* are predictions made by Old Testament prophets about the coming of a righteous King who would rule Israel according to the will of God.
- These Messianic prophecies were fulfilled through Jesus Christ.

2.10. Nathan's prophecy about the Messiah

2 Samuel 7:12-13, 2 Samuel 7:16

According to these verses, Nathan prophesied that the Messiah would:

- Be a descendant of King David.
- Establish an everlasting kingdom.
- Rule over Israel forever.
- Deliver Israel from her political enemies.
- Always be supported by God.
- Be a great king whose kingdom would be kept strong.
- Have His throne established forever.

2.11. Isaiah's prophecy about the Messiah

Isaiah 7:10-16, Isaiah 9:1-7, and Isaiah 61:1-3

- Prophet Isaiah made a prophecy about *Immanuel*. He went to King Ahaz of Judah to give him a sign of assurance that God would be with him in the threat he faced from Syria and Israel.

- King Ahaz was told to trust in God for deliverance from the enemy. The sign was a prophecy which stated:
'Behold, a young woman shall conceive and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.'
- This prophecy looks forward to the restoration of the Kingdom of David under a righteous descendant of David. The Messiah (the coming king) was to have titles such as:
 - o Wonderful Counsellor
 - o Mighty God
 - o Everlasting Father
 - o Prince of Peace
- According to Isaiah, the character and mission of the Messiah included:
 - o He will be filled with the Holy Spirit.
 - o He has been anointed by God.
 - o He has been sent to bring good news to the poor.
 - o He has been sent to bring liberty (freedom) to the captives.
 - o He has been sent to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor.

2.12. Isaiah's prophecy about the suffering servant

Isaiah 53

Prophet Isaiah speaks about the *Suffering Servant of God*, who is believed by Christians to refer to the Messiah (Jesus Christ).

According to Isaiah, the Suffering Servant would have the following characteristics:

1. The Servant would succeed in His work and be highly honored.
2. His success and honor would surprise many who had witnessed His suffering.
3. He would be rejected and despised by many.
4. He would be treated harshly, arrested and sentenced to death—executed in a shameful way.
5. He would be wounded for the transgressions of the people.
6. His suffering would be according to God's will.
7. He would have nothing physically attractive—He would appear ordinary and simple.
8. He would be harshly treated, wounded and known as a man of sorrow.
9. He would endure all that was done to Him in silence, without protest.

2.13. Jeremiah's prophecy about the Messiah

Jeremiah 23:5-6

Jeremiah prophesied that God would raise a righteous descendant of David.

This future king (the Messiah) would:

1. Rule wisely.
2. Advocate for justice and righteousness.
3. Save Judah from her enemies and ensure that the Israelites live in safety.
4. Be called "The Lord is Our Righteousness."

2.14. Micah's prophecy about the Messiah

Micah 5:2-5

Prophet Micah prophesied that the Messiah:

1. Would be born in Bethlehem, the city of David.
2. Would come from ancient origins (His coming is from of old).
3. Would lead His people with the authority and strength of God.
4. Would bring peace to Israel, fulfilling God's promise to King David.
5. Shall be great to the ends of the earth.
6. Would feed His flock like a shepherd.

2.15. The Psalmist's prophecy about the Messiah

Psalm 110:1-2

According to the Psalmist:

- The Messiah would rule from Zion.
- He would be honored by God and rule as God's representative on earth.
- He would enjoy God's protection and achieve victory over His enemies.
- He would sit at the right hand of God, a position of authority and honor.

2.16. How Jesus fulfilled the Old Testament prophecies concerning the Messiah

- a) Jesus was a descendant of David, as Nathan had prophesied.
- b) The angel Gabriel told Mary that Jesus would inherit David's throne and rule forever.
- c) The angel Gabriel told Mary that Jesus would be called Immanuel, fulfilling Isaiah's prophecy.
- d) Jesus was born in Bethlehem, the town of David, as Micah predicted.
- e) A blind beggar called Jesus "Son of David," showing people recognized Him as the Messiah.
- f) Simeon said Jesus would bring salvation to the whole world.
- g) Jesus performed miracles like healing the sick and raising the dead, fulfilling Isaiah's prophecy.
- h) Jesus' suffering and death fulfilled Isaiah's prophecy of the suffering servant.

2.17. Role of John the Baptist as a link between the Old and New Testament

Isaiah 40:3-5, Malachi 3:1, Malachi 4:5-6, Luke 7:20-35

1. John the Baptist was the link between the Old and New Testament. He prepared the people for the coming of the Messiah by calling them to repent and be baptized.
2. He baptized people in the River Jordan. His ministry was prophetic and he is believed to have had the power and spirit of the prophet Elijah.
3. John had similar characteristics to Elijah. He lived a simple life of fasting and prayer, wore clothes made of camel's skin and ate wild honey and locusts.
4. He preached about Jesus as the Lamb of God – the one who would take away the sins of the world.
5. John introduced Jesus to the people of Israel as the promised Messiah. He also baptized Jesus in the River Jordan.
6. He boldly condemned evil. He spoke out against the sins of King Herod, the Pharisees, and the Roman authorities.
7. John broke the 400 years of prophetic silence between the last Old Testament prophet (Malachi) and the coming of Jesus.

8. He ushered in the Messianic age. Jesus called John the Baptist *"the greatest of all the prophets."*
9. John said that the Messiah would be greater than him. He understood his role was to prepare the way for Jesus.

2.18. Annunciation of the birth of John the Baptist

Luke 1:5-25

- During the time of King Herod of Judea, there was a priest named Zechariah from the priestly family of Abijah.
- His wife, Elizabeth was also from a priestly family. Both were righteous before God but were childless and advanced in age.
- One day, as Zechariah was performing his priestly duty of burning incense in the temple, an angel of the Lord appeared to him.
- The angel told Zechariah not to be afraid and announced that his prayer had been heard—Elizabeth would bear a son and they should name him John.
- Zechariah doubted the angel's message, so he was struck dumb (unable to speak) until the child was born.
- The people outside the temple were surprised by his delay and when he came out unable to speak, they realized he had seen a vision.
- After his service, Zechariah returned home and Elizabeth **conceived**.

2.19. Annunciation of the birth of Jesus Christ

Luke 1:26-38

- In the sixth month of Elizabeth's pregnancy, the angel Gabriel was sent by God to a young virgin named Mary, who lived in Nazareth.
- Mary was engaged to Joseph, a descendant of King David.
- The angel greeted her and told her that she was highly favored and that the Lord was with her.
- Mary was troubled by the greeting, but Gabriel reassured her.
- He told her she would conceive by the power of the Holy Spirit and bear a son named Jesus.
- Gabriel also said:
 - o The child will be great and will be called the Son of the Most High God.
 - o The Lord God will give Him the throne of His father David.
 - o He will reign over the house of Jacob forever.
 - o His kingdom will never end.
- Mary asked how this could happen since she was a virgin.
- The angel explained that the Holy Spirit would come upon her and the child would be called the Son of God.
- Gabriel also told her that Elizabeth was in her sixth month of pregnancy, showing that nothing is impossible with God.
- Mary responded in faith, saying: *"I am the handmaid of the Lord; let it be done to me according to your word."*

2.20. Mary visits Elizabeth

Luke 1:39-56

- After the angel's visit, Mary went to visit her cousin Elizabeth.
- When Mary greeted her, the baby in Elizabeth's womb leapt for joy.
- Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit and recognized that Mary was carrying the Messiah.
- She blessed Mary and the child in her womb.
- Mary responded with a song of praise known as the Magnificat, thanking God for His goodness.
- Mary stayed with Elizabeth for about three months before returning home.

2.21. Birth of John the Baptist

Luke 1:57-80

- Elizabeth gave birth to a son, and both she and Zechariah were filled with joy.
- Friends and relatives came to celebrate the birth of the child.
- On the eighth day, the child was circumcised according to Jewish law and tradition.
- The people wanted to name the boy Zechariah, after his father.
- But Elizabeth insisted that he should be named John, the name given by the angel.
- The people objected, saying, "*No one in your family has that name.*"
- They asked Zechariah by making signs, since he was still unable to speak.
- Zechariah asked for a writing tablet and wrote, "*His name is John.*"
- Everyone was amazed, and immediately, Zechariah was able to speak again. He began praising God.
- All the neighbors were filled with awe, and people all over the region talked about what had happened.
- Everyone who heard about it wondered what this child would become, knowing that God's hand was upon him.
- The Holy Spirit came upon Zechariah, and he broke into a prophetic hymn, known as the Benedictus (Latin for "*blessed*").
- In this song, Zechariah praised God, expressing joy, gratitude and hope for the future. He thanked God for sending a savior and recognized that his son John would prepare the way for the Lord.

2.21. Birth of Jesus Christ

Luke 2:1-20

- Joseph and Mary traveled from Nazareth in Galilee to Bethlehem in Judea, the birthplace of King David.
- They went because Emperor Caesar Augustus had issued a census decree, requiring everyone to register in their ancestral hometown.
- While they were in Bethlehem, the time came for Mary to give birth.
- Since there were no rooms available at the inn, they stayed in a stable, where Jesus was born.
- Mary wrapped Him in swaddling clothes and laid Him in a manger.
- That night, shepherds were in the fields watching over their flocks.
- An angel of the Lord appeared to them, and they were afraid.

- The angel reassured them and said: *"Today, in the town of David, a Saviour has been born to you; He is Christ the Lord."*
- The angel told them they would find the baby wrapped in swaddling clothes and lying in a manger.
- Suddenly, a host of angels appeared, praising God and singing: *"Glory to God in the highest, and peace on earth to those with whom He is pleased."*
- After the angels left, the shepherds hurried to Bethlehem.
- They found Mary, Joseph and the baby, just as the angel had described.
- The shepherds shared the angel's message, and everyone who heard it was amazed.
- Then, the shepherds returned to their flocks, glorifying and praising God for all they had seen and heard.

2.23. Dedication of Jesus Christ

Luke 2:21-52

- After eight days, the baby was circumcised and named Jesus, as the angel had instructed.
- Mary and Joseph took Jesus to the temple in Jerusalem to present Him to the Lord, according to Jewish custom.
- In Jerusalem, there was a devout man named Simeon who was eagerly waiting for the salvation of Israel.
- The Holy Spirit had revealed to him that he would not die before seeing the Messiah.
- Guided by the Spirit, Simeon went to the temple.
- When Mary and Joseph brought Jesus, Simeon took the baby in his arms and praised God, saying that he had seen God's salvation.
- Also in the temple was Anna, a prophetess who was 84 years old.
- She had been widowed after seven years of marriage and had since spent her time fasting and praying in the temple.
- When she saw Jesus, she gave thanks to God and spoke about the child to everyone who was waiting for the redemption of Jerusalem.
- After fulfilling all the requirements of the law, Mary and Joseph returned to Nazareth, in Galilee.
- Jesus grew in wisdom, became strong and God's favor was upon Him.

2.24. Teachings of John the Baptist

Luke 3:1-20

- John the Baptist began preaching during the reign of Emperor Tiberius Caesar.
- At that time, Pontius Pilate was governor of Judea and Herod Antipas ruled Galilee.
- Main teachings of John the Baptist were:
 - a) Call to repentance - John urged people to repent, confess their sins and seek God's forgiveness. His baptism prepared people for the coming of one who would baptize with the Holy Spirit and fire.

- b) Warning against false security - He warned that being descendants of Abraham was not enough to escape God's judgment. He said God could raise children for Abraham even from stones, showing the importance of true repentance and not relying on ancestry.
- c) Clarification about the Messiah - Some people thought John was the Messiah, but he made it clear that someone greater was coming. This Messiah would baptize with the Holy Spirit and bring judgment to those who disobeyed God's law.
- d) Message of social justice - John taught about fairness, honesty and moral responsibility. He said that:
 - Those who had more should share with those in need.
 - Tax collectors should only collect what is required.
 - Soldiers should not take things by force or falsely accuse others.
 - He condemned King Herod for his immoral actions including marrying his brother's wife, Herodias.

2.25. Relevance of the teachings of John the Baptist to Christians today

- Christians should be fair and just in their dealings with others.
- Christians should avoid hypocrisy and live with honesty and integrity.
- Christians should remember that God will judge everyone for their actions.
- Christians should repent sincerely, seek forgiveness and be baptised.
- John challenges Christians to make the world a better place by avoiding corruption, immorality and injustice.
- Christians should care for the poor and needy, not oppress or ignore them.
- Christians should prepare their hearts for the coming of Jesus, just as John prepared people for His first coming.
- Christians are called to be bold and courageous in standing for the truth and speaking out against sin, just as John did.

2.26. Baptism of Jesus Christ

Luke 3:21-23

- After many people had been baptized by John the Baptist, Jesus also came to be baptized by him in the Jordan River.
- Jesus was sinless, yet He chose to be baptized to fulfill all righteousness and set an example for believers.
- As Jesus was praying, heaven opened, signaling a divine moment.
- The Holy Spirit descended on Jesus in the form of a dove, symbolizing peace and God's approval.
- A voice from heaven declared: *"You are my beloved Son; with you I am well pleased."*
- This voice confirmed Jesus' divine identity as the Son of God.
- Jesus was about 30 years old when He began His public ministry.
- The baptism marked the beginning of Jesus' mission to teach, heal, and save humanity.
- The event also revealed the Trinity: the Father (voice from heaven), the Son (Jesus) and the Holy Spirit (dove).

- Jesus' baptism demonstrated humility and obedience to God's plan.

2.27. Relevance of the baptism of Jesus Christ to Christians today

- It unites Christians as members of the body of Christ, which is the Church.
- Through baptism, one receives the Holy Spirit.
- Baptism marks the death of the old self and the beginning of a new life in Christ.
- Jesus was baptized, and Christians should emulate Him by following His example.
- One becomes a child of God after being baptized.
- Christians achieve complete forgiveness of sins through baptism.
- Baptism prepares Christians for the second coming of Jesus Christ.
- Baptism is an example of a modern religious covenant between the Christian and God.
- Baptism is a symbol of forgiveness of sins.

2.28. The temptations of Jesus Christ

Luke 4:1-13

- Jesus was led by the Holy Spirit into the wilderness, where He stayed for forty days without eating.
- He became very hungry.
- The devil tempted Jesus to turn a stone into bread, saying, *"If You are the Son of God, command this stone to become bread."*
- Jesus replied, *"Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God."*
- The devil then took Jesus to a high mountain and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world.
- He promised Jesus all the kingdoms if Jesus would worship him.
- Jesus answered, *"You shall worship the Lord your God and Him only shall you serve."*
- The devil next took Jesus to the pinnacle of the temple and urged Him to throw Himself down, saying that God would send angels to save Him.
- Jesus replied, *"You shall not put the Lord your God to the test."*
- After these temptations, the devil left Jesus and angels came to minister to Him.

2.29. Lessons learned from the temptations of Jesus Christ

- Since Jesus was tempted, He fully understands our struggles and is ready to help us when we are tempted.
- God does not allow us to be tempted beyond our strength; He always provides a way out.
- Followers of Jesus should expect to be tested in their loyalty to Him.
- Temptations and trials strengthen our faith in God.
- When tempted, we should turn to the Bible for guidance, as Jesus quoted Scripture during His temptations. Knowing God's word is essential for Christians.
- We should seek the Holy Spirit, who enabled Jesus to overcome the devil.
- We must avoid all forms of idolatry and worship only the one true God.
- Material possessions should never lead us into sin.
- Christians should have complete faith in God and never test Him.

- Power and authority alone cannot lead one to God's kingdom; only God should be worshipped and served.

2.30. Utilizing virtues exemplified by Jesus Christ to overcome temptations

1. Faith - Trusting fully in God helps you stand firm when faced with temptation, just as Jesus relied on God's power during His trials.
2. Perseverance - Helps you remain strong in your faith and resist temptation, even when facing challenges or peer pressure. It encourages you to keep trusting God and not give up when struggling with sin.
3. Holiness - Keeps you focused on living a life that pleases God. Striving for holiness helps you avoid sinful actions and surround yourself with positive influences to stay on the right path.
4. Love for God - Strengthens your desire to do what is right because you want to honor and please God. Loving God deeply makes you reject sin and choose righteousness.
5. Fear of God - Encourages you to make wise choices, knowing that God sees everything. This reverence for God's authority helps you avoid actions that go against His will.
6. Obedience to God - Teaches you to follow God's commandments, even when tempted to do otherwise. Practicing obedience helps develop discipline and self-control, which are essential in resisting temptation.

2.31. GALILEAN MINISTRY

2.32. Jesus Christ is rejected in Nazareth

Luke 4:14-30

- After His baptism and temptation, Jesus returned to Galilee filled with the power of the Holy Spirit.
- He went to His hometown, Nazareth and on the Sabbath, He went to the synagogue to teach.
- Jesus read from the scroll of Isaiah, declaring that He was the fulfillment of the prophecy – the one sent to bring good news to the poor, freedom for prisoners, sight to the blind and liberty to the oppressed.
- At first, the people were amazed at His words but soon became skeptical, questioning, *'Isn't this Joseph's son?'*
- Jesus anticipated their doubt and told them, *"No prophet is accepted in his hometown."*
- He reminded them of examples where prophets helped outsiders, implying that His mission extended beyond Israel.
- This angered the crowd and they tried to throw Him out of the town and kill Him by pushing Him off a cliff.
- Jesus miraculously escaped and went on His way.

2.33. Reasons why Jesus was rejected in Nazareth

1. He was the anointed one of God, fulfilling Isaiah's prophecy, but the people expected a political Messiah.

2. He did not perform the miracles in Nazareth that He did in Capernaum such as healing the sick and raising the dead.
3. He offended the listeners by reminding them that their ancestors had rejected and persecuted God's prophets, like during Elijah's time.
4. He told them that because they had rejected the good news, it would be offered to the Gentiles first.
5. Being His hometown, the people found it hard to believe Jesus' claims since they knew Him as a local boy.
6. The Jews in Nazareth were angered when Jesus compared them unfavorably with the Gentiles.

2.34. The miraculous catch of fish

Luke 5:1-11

- Jesus saw two boats by the shore where fishermen, including Simon Peter, were washing their nets after a night of no catch.
- Jesus got into Simon's boat and taught the crowd from there.
- After teaching, Jesus told Simon to go into deeper water and lower the nets again. Although Simon doubted, he obeyed Jesus and lowered the nets.
- They caught such a large number of fish that their nets began to break. They called James and John to help, and both boats filled so much that they started sinking.
- Overwhelmed, Simon Peter fell at Jesus' feet, feeling unworthy because of his sinfulness.
- Jesus reassured him not to be afraid and said, *"From now on, you will be catching men."*
- Simon Peter and the others left everything behind and followed Jesus.

2.35. Significance of the miraculous catch of fish to Christians today

- Christians should preach the good news to others.
- Christians should respond to God's call in obedience.
- Christians should acknowledge their sinful state and repent like Simon Peter did.
- Christians should work together as a team in the service of God.
- Christians should use the power of God to perform miracles.
- Christians should use their talents to serve God.
- God can choose anybody to serve Him regardless of their status in society.
- God still calls people today to serve Him in various capacities.
- Those called by God are expected to be humble.
- Christians should trust God's guidance even when it seems unlikely or difficult.
- Faith and obedience to God's instructions can lead to abundant blessings.

2.36. Jesus heals a man with leprosy

Luke 5:12-16

- A man suffering from leprosy approached Jesus with humility and faith, saying, "Lord, if you are willing, you can make me clean."
- Despite the social stigma and isolation caused by leprosy, the man courageously sought healing.

- Jesus, moved with compassion, touched him—a bold act since lepers were considered unclean. Jesus declared, "I am willing. Be clean!"
- Immediately, the man was healed and restored. Jesus instructed him not to tell anyone about the miracle but to follow the law by presenting himself to the priest and offering the required sacrifices as proof of his cleansing.
- Even though Jesus asked for secrecy, news of the healing spread quickly, drawing large crowds wherever Jesus went.
- Despite this, Jesus often withdrew to quiet places to pray and renew His connection with the Father.

2.37. Jesus heals a paralyzed man

Luke 5:17-26

- One day, while Jesus was teaching in a crowded house, a group of men brought a paralysed man to be healed.
- Unable to get through the crowd, they demonstrated great faith and creativity by lowering the man through the roof.
- Seeing their faith, Jesus said to the paralysed man, "Your sins are forgiven."
- This statement shocked the religious leaders present, especially the Pharisees, who accused Jesus of blasphemy since only God can forgive sins.
- Jesus challenged their thinking by asking which was easier to say: "Your sins are forgiven" or "Get up and walk?"
- To prove His authority, Jesus healed the man physically and the man immediately stood, walked and praised God.
- This miracle left everyone amazed and they glorified God for witnessing such remarkable power.

2.38. Jesus calls Levi (Matthew) and dines with sinners

Luke 5:27-32

- Jesus called Levi, a tax collector, who was often despised for working with the Roman occupiers and seen as a sinner by many Jews.
- Levi responded immediately by leaving his lucrative profession to follow Jesus.
- Later, Levi hosted a banquet to celebrate, inviting many fellow tax collectors and others considered sinners.
- The Pharisees were quick to criticize Jesus for eating and associating with such people, seeing it as a violation of religious purity.
- Jesus responded by explaining that His mission was to call sinners to repentance, not the self-righteous.
- He likened Himself to a doctor who comes to heal the sick, emphasizing that those who acknowledge their need for salvation are the ones He came to save.

2.39. A question about fasting

Luke 5:33-39

- Some people questioned why Jesus' disciples did not follow the religious tradition of fasting, especially like John the Baptist's followers who were known for their strict lifestyle.
- Jesus explained that fasting was inappropriate while He, the "bridegroom," was present with His people.
- He used two parables to illustrate the incompatibility of His new teaching with old religious customs: new cloth sewn onto old garments would tear away and new wine poured into old wineskins would burst them.
- This taught that Jesus' message and ministry were ushering in a new era that required a fresh approach to spirituality, not simply following old traditions.

2.40. Disciples ate heads of grain on the Sabbath

Luke 6:1-5

- On a Sabbath, Jesus and His disciples walked through grain fields, and the disciples picked some heads of grain to eat because they were hungry.
- The Pharisees, who were strict about Sabbath laws, accused them of doing something unlawful.
- Jesus responded by referring to a story from the Old Testament where King David and his companions ate consecrated bread reserved only for priests when they were hungry.
- Jesus then declared, "The Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath," asserting His authority over Sabbath rules and emphasizing that human need and compassion take priority over ritualistic law.

2.41. Jesus heals a man with a withered hand

Luke 6:6-11

- On another Sabbath, Jesus was teaching in a synagogue when He noticed a man with a withered right hand.
- The Pharisees and teachers of the law watched closely, hoping to catch Jesus breaking Sabbath laws by healing on the holy day.
- Knowing their thoughts, Jesus asked the crowd, *'Is it lawful to do good or to do evil on the Sabbath, to save life or to destroy it?'*
- Then, He told the man to stretch out his hand.
- As the man obeyed, his hand was completely restored.
- This miracle infuriated the religious leaders, who began plotting how to kill Jesus, seeing Him as a threat to their authority.

2.42. Reasons why Jesus faced opposition from the Pharisees and the Scribes

- He touched a man with leprosy, which was considered unlawful and made one ceremonially unclean according to Jewish law.
- He said that He came not for the righteous but for sinners, which offended the Pharisees who believed they were already righteous and superior to others.
- He ate with tax collectors and sinners, something the Pharisees strongly disapproved of, as they avoided socializing with people considered impure.

- His disciples did not fast like those of John the Baptist or the Pharisees, which was seen as a lack of religious discipline.
- His disciples plucked and ate grain on the Sabbath, which the Pharisees viewed as breaking Sabbath laws that prohibited work.
- He encouraged people to move away from rigid old traditions and embrace the new teachings and spiritual freedom He brought, which threatened the religious authority of the Pharisees.
- He healed a man with a withered hand on the Sabbath, which was considered by the Pharisees as working on a holy day, thus violating their interpretation of Sabbath observance.

2.43. Sermon on the plain

Luke 6:17-49

- After Jesus Christ chose His disciples, He came down the hill and stood on a level place. He gave a sermon to those present.
- The people had come to hear Jesus Christ's word, to receive healing from their diseases and for Jesus to exorcise unclean spirits from them.
- He addressed various issues concerning the community. The Sermon on the Plain consisted of five main parts:
 - ❖ Blessings and woes
 - ❖ Love of enemies
 - ❖ Judging others
 - ❖ Evidence of good
 - ❖ True discipleship
- The blessings and woes are as follows:
 - a) Blessed are you poor, for yours is the kingdom of God.
 - b) Blessed are you who hunger now, for you shall be satisfied.
 - c) Blessed are you who weep now, for you shall laugh.
 - d) Blessed are you when people hate you, and when they exclude you and revile you, and cast out your name as evil, on account of the Son of Man.
 - e) Rejoice in that day, and leap for joy, for behold, your reward is great in heaven; for so their fathers did to the prophets.
 - f) Woe to you who are rich, for you have received your consolation.
 - g) Woe to you who are full now, for you shall hunger.
 - h) Woe to you who laugh now, for you shall mourn and weep.
 - i) Woe to you when all people speak well of you, for so their fathers did to the false prophets.

2.44. Lessons learnt from the sermon on the plain

- The goal of Christians is to inherit the Kingdom of God.
- Christians should forgive their enemies, just as Jesus forgave those who crucified Him.
- Before judging others, we should first examine ourselves.
- Our faith should be strong and unwavering, as it helps us resist temptation.
- A Christian should be willing to hear God's word and proclaim it.

- We should promote peace.
- We should be generous.

2.45. Jesus' works of compassion and their relevance to Christians today

Compassion is a deep concern for those who are suffering, along with a strong desire to help them.

2.46. Healing of the Centurion's servant

Luke 7:1-10

- After delivering the Sermon on the Plain, Jesus returned to Capernaum.
- In the town, a centurion had a servant who was very ill and near death. The servant was highly valued by the centurion.
- When the centurion heard about Jesus, he sent some Jewish elders to ask Him to come and heal his servant.
- The elders pleaded with Jesus, saying the centurion was a good man who had even built a synagogue for them.
- Jesus agreed to go with them.
- Before Jesus arrived at the house, the centurion sent more messengers, saying he was not worthy to have Jesus enter his home.
- He asked Jesus to just say the word and he believed his servant would be healed.
- The centurion explained that he understood authority—just as he gave commands to soldiers and they obeyed, he believed Jesus' command would bring healing.
- Jesus was amazed by the centurion's great faith. He told the crowd that He had not found such faith even in Israel.
- When the messengers returned home, they found the servant completely healed.

2.47. Lessons learnt from the healing of the centurion's servant

Just as the centurion believed in the power of Jesus' word to heal, Christians should have faith in Jesus' authority and Lordship.

Christians should trust that Jesus has the power to heal all forms of illnesses.

Just as the centurion showed great love for his servant, Christian employers should treat their workers with kindness and compassion.

Despite his high status, the centurion humbled himself before Jesus; likewise, leaders should practise humility and seek God's guidance.

Christians should show compassion to those in need, just as Jesus showed mercy and healed the centurion's servant.

2.48. Raising of the Widow's Son in Nain

Luke 7:11-17

- Jesus travelled to the town of Nain in Galilee, accompanied by His disciples and a large crowd.
- As He approached the entrance to the town, He encountered a funeral procession. The deceased was the only son of a widow and a large group of mourners from the town was with her.

- When Jesus saw the grieving mother, His heart was filled with compassion. He said to her, *'Do not weep.'*
- Then, He stepped forward and touched the coffin, causing the men carrying it to stop. Jesus commanded, *'Young man, I say to you, arise.'*
- Immediately, the dead man sat up and began to speak. Jesus then gave him back to his mother.
- A sense of awe filled the crowd and they praised God, saying, *'A great prophet has arisen among us!'* and *'God has visited His people!'*
- News of this miracle spread throughout the region and the surrounding areas.
- From the raising of the widow's son in Nain, Christians learn that:
 1. They should show compassion to the needy, just as Jesus did.
 2. Jesus Christ has power over death, showing His divine authority.
 3. Jesus Christ is the promised Messiah, as He performed miracles foretold in prophecy.
 4. Traditions should not hinder us from doing what is right or showing love and mercy.

2.49. The question on the Messiah

Luke 7:18-35

- John the Baptist sent two of his disciples to Jesus with the question: *"Are you the one who is to come or shall we look for another?"*
- When they found Jesus, He was healing many people of sickness, diseases and evil spirits and restoring sight to the blind.
- Jesus told them to go back to John and report what they had witnessed:
 - o The blind receiving sight
 - o The lame walking
 - o Lepers being cleansed
 - o The deaf hearing
 - o The dead being raised
 - o The good news being preached to the poor
- After the disciples left, Jesus spoke to the crowd about John the Baptist:
 - o He honoured John as the greatest of all prophets
 - o He recognised John's unique role in preparing the way for the Messiah
 - o Jesus noted that those in the Kingdom of God are greater than John, highlighting the new era brought by the Messiah

2.50. The forgiving of the sinful woman

Luke 7:36-50

- A Pharisee named Simon invited Jesus to dine at his house.
- A woman known to be sinful (likely a social outcast) entered the house carrying an alabaster jar of perfume.
- She stood behind Jesus, weeping. She washed His feet with her tears, dried them with her hair, kissed His feet, and poured perfume on them.
- Simon thought to himself, *"If Jesus were a prophet, He would know what kind of woman is touching Him."*

- Jesus, knowing Simon's thoughts, told a parable about two people who owed money. One owed 500 denarii, the other 50 denarii, and both debts were forgiven.
- Jesus asked Simon, *"Which of them will love the lender more?"* Simon replied, *"The one who had the bigger debt forgiven."*
- Jesus contrasted the woman's acts of love and humility with Simon's lack of hospitality: Simon did not provide water for Jesus' feet, no kiss of greeting, and no oil for His head.
- Jesus said the woman's actions showed her deep love because *"her many sins have been forgiven."*
- Jesus told the woman, *"Your sins are forgiven"* and *"Your faith has saved you; go in peace."*
- The other guests were shocked that Jesus claimed to forgive sins.

2.51. Parables of Jesus Christ and their relevance to Christians today

- A parable is a short, simple story with a hidden meaning that teaches a moral or spiritual lesson.
- Jesus used parables to teach about the Kingdom of God, human behaviour and God's expectations.

2.52. Parable of the Sower

- A large crowd gathered before Jesus, and He told them the parable of a man who went out to sow seeds in a field.
- As he sowed, the seeds fell on different types of ground:
 - Some fell along the footpath, where they were trampled and eaten by birds.
 - Some fell on rocky ground; they sprouted but quickly withered because the soil had no moisture.
 - Some fell among thorny bushes, which grew alongside them and choked the plants.
 - But some fell on good soil, where they thrived and produced a plentiful harvest, yielding a hundred grains each.
- The disciples asked Jesus to explain the meaning of the parable. He said:
 - The seed is the word of God.
 - The seeds that fell along the footpath represent those who hear the word, but the devil takes it away from their hearts to prevent them from believing and being saved.
 - The seeds that fell on rocky ground symbolize those who hear the message and receive it with joy. However, since it does not take root deeply, they believe only for a short time, and when faced with temptation, they fall away.
 - The seeds that fell among thorns stand for those who hear the word, but the worries, riches, and pleasures of life overwhelm them, preventing their faith from maturing and bearing fruit.
 - The seeds that fell on good soil represent those who hear the message, embrace it with a sincere and obedient heart, and persist in their faith until they bear fruit.
- The lessons Christians learn from the parable of the sower include:
 - Christians are called to share God's word, just as the sower spreads seeds, knowing that not everyone will accept it, but some will bear fruit.

- They should be receptive to God's word and not allow distractions to hinder their spiritual growth.
- They are encouraged not to lose hope, because a great reward awaits those who remain faithful.
- They must guard against worries, wealth and pleasures, which can distract them from hearing and understanding God's word.
- Faith requires a strong foundation to grow and thrive, just as seeds need good soil to flourish.

2.53. Parable of the lamp under a bowl

Luke 8:16-21

- In this parable, Jesus taught that no one lights a lamp only to hide it under a bowl or a bed. Instead, they place it on a stand so it can brighten the room.
- Jesus represents the light, and the disciples are those who receive that light and reflect it. Their duty was to share what they had learned from Him rather than keep it to themselves.
- He urged them to listen carefully and understand His teachings. Jesus also warned that their mission required giving in order to receive. If they failed to preach God's word and bear fruit, they would lose even the little spiritual knowledge they had been given.
- Jesus' mother and brothers came to see Him, but they could not reach Him because of the crowd. Someone told Jesus that His family was waiting outside.
- In response, Jesus said that His true mother and brothers are those who hear and obey God's word. He also said that whatever is hidden will be brought out into the open, and what is covered will be brought to light.
- Jesus told the people to be careful how they listen: for the one who has, more will be given and from the one who does not have, even what he thinks he has will be taken away.
- The lessons Christians learn from the parable are:
 - ❖ Just as a lamp is placed on a stand to give light, Christians are called to share the Gospel and not keep their faith hidden.
 - ❖ Believers should live in a way that reflects God's love and truth, guiding others through their words and actions.
 - ❖ Christians are encouraged to embrace and nurture their faith, allowing it to shine brightly rather than being suppressed by fear or doubt.
 - ❖ The parable reminds Christians that they are responsible for using their gifts and knowledge to positively impact the world.
 - ❖ Just as light spreads when uncovered, those who share God's word will grow spiritually, while those who keep it to themselves may lose their understanding.

2.54. The mighty works of Jesus Christ and their significance

The mighty works of Jesus are called **miracles**.

2.55. The miracle of Jesus' healing in Capernaum

Luke 4:31-41

- Jesus went to Capernaum, a town in Galilee, where He taught the people on the Sabbath. They were amazed by His teaching because He spoke with authority.
- In the synagogue, there was a man possessed by an evil spirit. The demon inside him cried out, asking Jesus what He wanted with them. Recognizing Jesus as the Holy One of God, the demon questioned whether He had come to destroy them.
- Jesus firmly commanded the demon to be silent and come out of the man. Immediately, the demon threw the man to the ground but left him unharmed.
- The people were astonished and asked one another what kind of power and authority Jesus had. They marveled at how even evil spirits obeyed Him. News about Jesus quickly spread throughout the region.
- After leaving the synagogue, Jesus went to Simon's house, where Simon's mother-in-law was suffering from a high fever. The people asked Jesus to heal her, and He rebuked the fever. Instantly, she was healed and got up to serve them.
- That evening, many people with various illnesses and those possessed by demons were brought to Jesus. He healed the sick and cast out demons from the afflicted.
- The crowd wanted Jesus to stay with them, but He told them that He must continue spreading the Good News of God's Kingdom to others, because His mission was for all people.
- Lessons Christians Learn from Jesus' Healing in Capernaum:
 - Jesus is the Son of God.
 - Jesus came to establish God's Kingdom and defeat the power of Satan.
 - Jesus has authority over evil spirits and demons.
 - Faith and prayer are essential for healing.
 - Jesus came to free humanity from the bondage of sin.

2.56. Jesus calms the storm

Luke 8:22-25

- It was evening. After a long day of teaching crowds by the Sea of Galilee, Jesus said to His disciples, *'Let us go over to the other side.'* So they got into a boat and set out, leaving the crowds behind.
- As they sailed, Jesus, weary from ministry, fell asleep on a cushion in the stern of the boat.
- Then came a violent storm. Wind howled. Waves crashed. Water began to flood the boat. Seasoned fishermen panicked.
- In terror, they woke Jesus, shouting, *'Teacher, don't you care that we're going to drown?'*
- Jesus stood, looked out over the chaos and said simply, *'Peace, be still.'* Instantly, the wind stopped. The sea became calm. The silence was almost as terrifying as the storm had been. *'Why are you so afraid?'* He asked. *'Do you still have no faith?'*
- The disciples were in awe. *'Who is this,'* they whispered, *'that even the wind and the sea obey Him?'*

2.57. Healing of the Gerasene Demoniac

Luke 8:26-39

- They reached the region of the Gerasene, across the lake. As Jesus stepped ashore, a wild man came running from the tombs. He was possessed by many demons.
- People had tried to bind him with chains, but he would break free. He lived among the dead, howling day and night, cutting himself with stones.
- When he saw Jesus, he ran and fell before Him, shouting, *'What do you want with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? Don't torment me!'*
- Jesus asked, *'What is your name?'*
The man replied, *'Legion, for we are many.'*
- The demons begged Jesus not to send them away but into a herd of pigs nearby. Jesus permitted it.
- The demons entered the pigs; about 2,000 of them, and the herd rushed down the steep bank into the lake and drowned.
- The herdsmen ran into town. When the people came and saw the once-possessed man sitting clothed and in his right mind, they were afraid.
- They begged Jesus to leave their region. As Jesus got back in the boat, the man begged to go with Him.
- But Jesus said, *'Go home to your people and tell them how much the Lord has done for you.'* And the man did, proclaiming throughout the city how Jesus had healed him.

2.58. Healing of the woman with a flow of blood

Luke 8:43-48

- Back across the lake, crowds gathered around Jesus again. Among them was a woman who had suffered from bleeding for twelve years.
- She had spent all she had on doctors, but no one could heal her. She thought, *'If I just touch His cloak, I will be healed.'*
- Quietly, she came up behind Jesus in the crowd and touched the edge of His garment.
- Immediately, the bleeding stopped. She knew she was healed.
- But Jesus stopped. *'Who touched Me?'* He asked. The disciples were puzzled, so many people were pressing in! But Jesus insisted.
- The woman, trembling, came forward and confessed everything.
- Jesus looked at her kindly and said, *'Daughter, your faith has made you well. Go in peace.'*

2.59. Raising of Jairus' daughter

Luke 8:49-56

- Before the woman had even finished speaking, messengers arrived with grim news. *'Your daughter is dead,'* they told Jairus, a synagogue leader who had earlier begged Jesus to heal his dying child. *'Don't bother the Teacher anymore.'*
- But Jesus said to Jairus, *'Do not be afraid. Just believe and she will be healed.'*
- They arrived at Jairus' house. Mourners were weeping loudly. Jesus said, *'She is not dead but asleep.'* The people laughed at Him.
- Jesus took only Peter, James, John and the girl's parents inside.
- He took the child's hand and said, *'Child, arise.'* Immediately, she got up.

- Jesus ordered that something should be given to her to eat. She was twelve years old.
- Everyone was astonished, but Jesus ordered them not to tell anyone what had happened and told them to give her something to eat.

2.60. Jesus feeds five thousand people

Luke 9:10-17

- When the apostles returned, they reported to Jesus what they had done. He took them with Him and they withdrew by themselves to a town called Bethsaida.
- But the crowds found out and followed Him. He welcomed them and spoke to them about the Kingdom of God, and healed those who needed healing.
- Late in the afternoon, the Twelve came to Him and said, *"Send the crowd away so they can go to the surrounding villages and countryside and find food and lodging, because we are in a remote place here."*
- He replied, *"You give them something to eat."*
They answered, *"We have only five loaves of bread and two fish—unless we go and buy food for all this crowd."*
- (About five thousand men were there.) But He said to His disciples, *"Have them sit down in groups of about fifty each."*
The disciples did so, and everyone sat down.
- Taking the five loaves and the two fish and looking up to heaven, He gave thanks and broke them.
- Then He gave them to the disciples to distribute to the people.
- They all ate and were satisfied, and the disciples picked up twelve basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over.

2.61. Transfiguration of Jesus Christ

Luke 9:28-36

- This is the change of form or transformation of body into heavenly glory.
- About a week after Jesus spoke of His coming suffering and death, He took Peter, John and James up on the mountain to pray.
- As He prayed, His face changed and His clothes became dazzling white.
- Suddenly, two men—**Moses and Elijah**—appeared in heavenly glory and began speaking with Jesus.
- They discussed how He would soon fulfill God's purpose by dying in Jerusalem.
- Meanwhile, Peter, John, and James had fallen into a deep sleep.
- When they woke up, they saw Jesus in His glory and the two men standing with Him.
- Overcome with awe, Peter said to Jesus, *"Master, it is well that we are here. Let us make three booths: one for You, one for Moses, and one for Elijah."*
- While Peter was still speaking, a cloud appeared and covered them, casting its shadow over them.
- Fear gripped the disciples as the cloud surrounded them.
- Then a voice from the cloud declared, *"This is My Son, My Chosen One; listen to Him!"*

2.62. Significance of the transfiguration

- The voice from Heaven reaffirmed that Jesus was the true Son of God and that He was fulfilling God's will.
- The Transfiguration served to strengthen the faith of the disciples, preparing them to continue with Jesus's work after His death.
- Moses represented the Law, while Elijah symbolized the Prophets. Their presence signified the transition from the Old Testament to its fulfillment in Jesus Christ.
- The cloud symbolized God's presence, just as it did in the Old Testament during events like the Exodus.
- Jesus' mission was no longer a secret; His divine identity and purpose were revealed more clearly to the disciples.
- The Transfiguration marked the beginning of His journey toward suffering and death, showing that glory would come through sacrifice.

2.63. Relevance of the Galilean ministry to Christians today

- It reminds Christians to serve others humbly, just as Jesus did among the poor, sick and outcast in Galilee.
- It calls believers to spread the Gospel actively, as Jesus did by preaching in villages and towns, reaching everyday people.
- It highlights the need for faith in action, not just belief, through acts of compassion, healing and forgiveness.
- It shows that God's message is for everyone, not just the religious elite—Jesus ministered to Gentiles, women, sinners and the marginalized.
- It inspires Christians to remain faithful through trials, as Jesus did, even when misunderstood or rejected by His own people.
- It encourages personal transformation as seen in the lives of people who encountered Jesus and were changed.
- It emphasizes the value of teaching and discipleship, urging Christians to grow in the Word and help others do the same.
- It challenges believers to live with integrity and authenticity, reflecting the love and truth of Christ in everyday life.

2.64. PAUL'S FIRST LETTER TO THE CORINTHIANS**2.65. Causes of division in the early church of Corinth**

1 Corinthians 1:10-31 and 1 Corinthians 3:1-9

- a) The believers divided themselves based on their loyalty to different church leaders, such as Paul, Apollos and Cephas. This created conflict and competition instead of unity within the church.

- b) The Corinthians viewed their leaders from a worldly perspective, valuing personal preference over the true role of ministers, as servants of Christ. Paul reminded them that both he and Apollos were simply workers in God's field.
- c) They lacked spiritual maturity, which led them to act in a worldly and fleshly manner, emphasizing human wisdom rather than the wisdom that comes from God.
- d) Paul criticized the Corinthians for boasting in human wisdom, rather than in the wisdom of God, which is revealed through Christ. Their admiration of intellect and eloquence contributed to the divisions.
- e) Some members took pride in their association with certain leaders, boasting about them instead of giving glory to Christ, the true foundation of the church.

2.66. Ways in which Paul addressed divisions in the church of Corinth

- Paul urged believers to focus on Christ rather than individual leaders, reminding them that they all belong to Him.
- He emphasized that love is the foundation of Christian unity and should guide their relationships.
- Paul warned against dividing into groups based on loyalty to different leaders, stressing that all serve the same God.
- He urged the Corinthians to avoid pride and instead embrace humility, which fosters unity.
- Paul taught that spiritual gifts should be used to strengthen the entire Church rather than create divisions.
- He advised believers to forgive one another in order to maintain peace and unity.
- Paul used the analogy of the body to show that every member has an important role and all must work together in harmony.

2.67. Moral challenges facing the youth today

1. Peer pressure - Influence from friends to engage in risky behaviours such as drug use, cheating or absenteeism in school.
2. Drug and substance use - Experimentation with drugs, alcohol and tobacco, which can lead to addiction and serious health problems.
3. Sexual immorality - Engaging in risky sexual behaviour, resulting in teenage pregnancies and sexually transmitted infections (STIs).
4. Dishonesty - Engaging in acts such as lying, stealing and cheating in school or social settings, which undermines trust and integrity.
5. Laziness - Avoiding responsibilities and failing to put effort into personal, academic or spiritual growth, leading to underachievement.
6. Irresponsibility - Lack of accountability in handling duties and making decisions, especially in schoolwork, relationships and finances.
7. Addiction to social media - Excessive use of digital platforms that results in poor moral judgment, reduced focus and exposure to harmful content.
8. Gambling - Involvement in betting or games of chance, which can lead to addiction, financial loss and moral compromise.

9. Mental health challenges - Struggles with depression, anxiety and low self-esteem, which can affect responsible decision-making and behaviour.

2.68. Possible solutions to the moral challenges facing the youth today

1. Parents and guardians should set good examples by practising strong moral values and guiding their children in making ethical decisions.
2. Schools should integrate moral education into the curriculum to teach learners about honesty, respect, responsibility and empathy.
3. Mentorship programs should be established, where experienced individuals guide and support young people in navigating moral dilemmas.
4. Encouraging positive peer relationships helps youth associate with friends who uphold good moral values and engage in constructive activities.
5. Involvement in community service and volunteer work should be promoted to instill a sense of responsibility and compassion.
6. Counselling services should be provided in schools and communities to help youth deal with peer pressure, identity crises and other moral challenges.
7. Guidance on responsible digital usage should be offered by parents and educators to prevent exposure to harmful content on social media and online platforms.
8. Youth should be taught self-control and decision-making skills to resist negative influences and make morally upright choices.

2.69. How Paul addressed the issue of immorality in the church of Corinth

- Paul strongly warned the Corinthians about immorality and gave clear instructions on how to handle it. Through his teachings, Paul encouraged the Corinthians to live holy lives and turn away from sin.
- In 1 Corinthians 5:1-5, Paul criticized the church for allowing a man to have a relationship with his father's wife. He instructed them to remove this man from the church community so that he could realize his sin, repent and be saved.
- In 1 Corinthians 5:9-13, Paul told Christians not to associate with people who claim to be believers but continue living in sin. He reminded them that the church must discipline its members and remove those who refuse to change.
- In 1 Corinthians 6:9, Paul reminded them that sinful people will not inherit God's kingdom. He warned that sin separates people from God and that those who persist in unrighteousness endanger their salvation.
- In 1 Corinthians 6:12-20, Some Corinthians believed they could do whatever they wanted with their bodies. Paul corrected them, saying that the body belongs to God and should not be used for immorality. He reminded them that their bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit and should be used to honour God.

3. CHURCH IN ACTION

3.1. THE HOLY SPIRIT

3.2. Day of the Pentecost

Acts 2:1-13

- Before His ascension, Jesus instructed His disciples to remain in Jerusalem until they received the Holy Spirit, who would enable them to go out and be His witnesses to the world.
- On the day of Pentecost, all the disciples were gathered in one place. Suddenly, a sound like that of a mighty wind came from heaven. It filled the whole house where the disciples were sitting.
- The disciples saw what looked like tongues of fire, distributed and resting on each one of them. They were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other languages as the Spirit enabled them.
- The multitude that was in Jerusalem was attracted by the great sound. They were amazed and surprised, as they heard the disciples, who were Galileans, speaking in their own languages, talking about the mighty works of God.
- Some of the people who had gathered were stunned and wondered what this meant. Others mocked the disciples, saying that they were drunk.

3.3. Outpouring of the holy spirit on the day of Pentecost

- Pentecost is the day the Holy Spirit descended on the disciples, empowering them to speak in different languages and marking the birth of the Christian Church.
- On the day of Pentecost, the disciples of Jesus Christ were gathered in one room in Jerusalem. They were still there because Jesus had instructed them to remain until He sent them a helper.
- On this day, the Holy Spirit descended on the disciples in the form of a strong wind and tongues of fire that rested on each one of them.
- The disciples then began to speak in different languages as the Holy Spirit gave them utterance, declaring the mighty works of God.
- People from different nations who were in Jerusalem heard the disciples speaking in their own native languages and were amazed by what they witnessed.
- Some of the crowd were amazed and curious, while others mocked the disciples, claiming they were drunk.
- This outpouring of the Holy Spirit was the fulfilment of the prophecy by Prophet Joel, who had foretold that God would pour out His Spirit on all people.

3.4. Peter's message on the day of Pentecost

Acts 2:14-41

- Peter defended the disciples, saying they were not drunk, but had been filled with the Holy Spirit, which enabled them to speak in different languages.
- He explained that what was happening was a **fulfilment of the prophecy of Joel**, which stated:
 - o In the last days, God would pour out His Spirit on all people.
 - o Sons and daughters would speak God's message.
 - o Young men would see visions and old men would dream dreams.

- God would show wonders in the heavens and signs on the earth including blood, fire and vapour of smoke.
- The sun would be turned into darkness and the moon into blood before the great day of the Lord comes.
- Whoever calls on the name of the Lord will be saved.
- Peter then spoke about Jesus of Nazareth, reminding the people of:
 - His miracles and signs,
 - His crucifixion, which happened according to God's plan,
 - And His resurrection, proving that Jesus had conquered death.
- Peter declared that Jesus had been exalted to the right hand of God and that He is truly both Lord and Messiah.
- The crowd was deeply moved and asked Peter and the other apostles, "*What shall we do?*"
- Peter urged them to repent and be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ so that their sins would be forgiven and they would receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.
- About three thousand people accepted the message that day and were baptised, marking the beginning of the early Church.

3.5. Lessons learnt from the day of Pentecost

1. **God keeps His promises.** The day of Pentecost is important because it reminds us that God fulfills His promises. Before ascending to heaven, Jesus promised His disciples a helper, the Holy Spirit, who came upon them on this day.
2. **The Holy Spirit gives courage to witness.** The Holy Spirit empowers believers to boldly share the Gospel. Peter, who had once denied Jesus, became courageous and preached fearlessly after being filled with the Holy Spirit.
3. **The Holy Spirit enables communication across boundaries.** On the day of Pentecost, the disciples spoke in different languages, showing that the message of Christ is for all people, regardless of nationality or language.
4. **The birth of the Christian Church.** The day of Pentecost marked the beginning of the Christian community, as about 3,000 people repented and were baptised.
5. **Christians should witness the risen Christ.** Like Peter and the other disciples, Christians today are called to share the message of Jesus' resurrection and salvation.
6. **Obedience leads to blessings.** The disciples obeyed Jesus' instruction to wait in Jerusalem for the Holy Spirit and they received the promised gift. Obedience to God brings spiritual rewards.
7. **Repentance is necessary to receive the Holy Spirit.** Peter told the people to repent and be baptised so they could receive the gift of the Holy Spirit. This shows that repentance is essential for spiritual transformation.

3.6. Jesus' teachings on the role of the holy spirit

John 14:15-17, John 14:25-26, John 16:7-15, Acts 1:6-8

- The Holy Spirit reveals the truth about God.
- The Holy Spirit comforts and counsels Christians.
- The Holy Spirit empowers believers to proclaim the Gospel fearlessly.

- The Holy Spirit teaches and reminds disciples of Jesus' words and actions.
- The Holy Spirit strengthens the faith of believers and gives courage during persecution.
- The Holy Spirit helps believers understand that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.
- The Holy Spirit convicts people of their sin and leads them to repentance.
- The Holy Spirit unites all believers into one body – the Church.

3.7. GIFTS OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

- Gifts of the Holy Spirit refer to the extraordinary ability, grace, special abilities or talents given by the Holy Spirit to a believer, allowing them to perform specific actions or ministries that build up the church.
- The Holy Spirit gives Christians extraordinary abilities, favors and talents.
- God expects us to use these gifts for the benefit of all. Christians should use the gifts to serve others and the Church.
- Gifts of the Holy Spirit should not be used for one's glory or benefit.

3.8. Classifying gifts of the holy spirit

1 Corinthians 12:8-11

- The gifts of the Holy Spirit are:
 - Wisdom
 - Knowledge
 - Faith
 - Healing
 - Prophecy
 - Working of miracles
 - Speaking in tongues
 - Interpretation of tongues
 - The ability to distinguish between spirits
- The gifts of the Holy Spirit are classified into three categories:
 - **Gifts of knowledge** - These include gifts of knowledge, wisdom and discernment.
 - **Gifts of power** - These include gifts of working miracles, healing and faith.
 - **Gifts of divine utterance** - These include gifts of prophecy, speaking in tongues and interpretation of tongues.

3.9. Criteria for discerning the gifts of the Holy Spirit

1 Corinthians 12:1-3, Mathew 7:15-20, Galatians 5:16-26

- One who is under the influence of the Holy Spirit will confess Jesus as Lord *and Savior*.
- The teaching should be about Jesus Christ's doctrine.
- They should possess the fruit of the Holy Spirit such as love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control.
- They should not contradict the teachings of Jesus Christ.
- A believer who leads a victorious life overcomes temptations.

- A believer who is under the influence of the Holy Spirit will never curse Jesus.
- Those who possess the gifts of the Holy Spirit do not use them for selfish gains.
- The manifestations of the Holy Spirit should conform to the teachings of the Bible.

3.10. Manifestation of the Gifts of the Holy Spirit in the church today

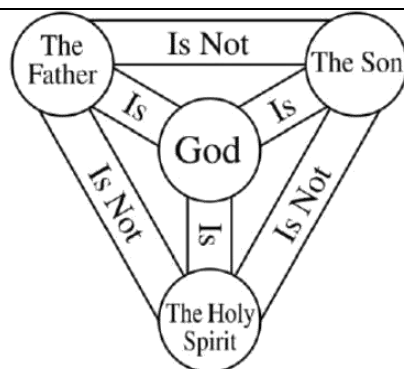
- Some believers receive the gift of prophecy to speak messages from God about individuals, the church or future events.
- Certain members are enabled by the Holy Spirit to speak in unknown languages (tongues) while others have the gift to interpret these messages for the congregation.
- The Holy Spirit grants some Christians the ability to pray for and heal others suffering from illnesses, leading to physical and spiritual restoration.
- The gift of wisdom helps believers make sound, Godly decisions in church leadership and personal life situations.
- Some Christians manifest strong, unwavering faith that inspires others and helps overcome challenges and doubts.
- Church leaders and teachers are gifted to understand and explain the Scriptures clearly, applying God's Word to everyday life.
- The Holy Spirit empowers believers to endure hardships and wait patiently on God's timing.
- The gifts promote unity among believers, encouraging them to support and care for one another within the church community.
- Some are given the ability to discern true spiritual messages from false ones, protecting the church from deception.
- The Holy Spirit empowers certain believers to perform miracles that demonstrate God's power and confirm His message.
- Gifts that build up, encourage and comfort others are evident as the Spirit works through believers in the church.

3.11. THE HOLY TRINITY

3.12. Meaning of the Holy Trinity

2 Corinthians 13:14, Deuteronomy 6:4, Mathew 3:16-17, Luke 1:35

- The Holy Trinity is the Christian belief that one God exists in three divine persons: God the Father, God the Son and God the Holy Spirit.
- God the Father represents God the Creator.
- God the Son is Jesus Christ, who lived on earth and died for the forgiveness of our sins.
- God the Holy Spirit refers to God's presence among His creation.



- The Holy Spirit empowers us to do God's work and also counsels and guides us.

3.13. Role of the Holy Trinity in the life of a Christian

- God the Father is the Creator and Provider who cares for and guides His people.
- Jesus Christ, the Son, is the Savior who brings salvation and connects us to God.
- The Holy Spirit is our Helper who gives us strength, wisdom and comfort.
- Together, the Holy Trinity helps Christians grow in faith and live according to God's will.

3.14. Doctrine of one God is christianity

Isaiah 44:6-8, Deuteronomy 32:39, 1 Timothy 2:5

- Monotheism in Christianity is the belief in one true God, who exists as the Father, Son (Jesus Christ) and Holy Spirit. This belief is known as the Holy Trinity.
- There is only one true God who exists in three persons.
- The true God is holy, powerful, gracious and unique.
- We should recognize the monotheistic doctrine in Christianity by worshipping the one true God.
- God is unique and does not share His nature with any other being.

3.15. SACRAMENTS

- A sacrament is a holy ceremony that represents God's grace and strengthens a believer's faith.
- It is an important act in Christianity, serving as a sign of God's presence and blessing.
- Different churches recognize different sacraments, but the most common ones are Baptism and Holy Communion (Eucharist).
- These sacraments help Christians grow spiritually and deepen their connection with God.

3.16. Meaning of baptism from the scriptures

Mark 6:16, John 3:5, Romans 6:1-14

- Baptism refers to the Christian sacrament of purification involving the use of water. It symbolizes the believer's faith in Christ, the forgiveness of sins and entry into the Christian community.
- Baptism symbolizes spiritual rebirth, marking the start of a new life in Christ. It emphasizes the necessity of the Holy Spirit's work in the believer's life for true transformation.
- It is an act of faith and obedience to the commands of Christ.

- Baptism marks the beginning of a new life.
- Baptism declares that you are a follower of Jesus Christ. It is a public confession of your faith in and commitment to Jesus Christ.
- Baptism also connects us to the body of Christ.

3.17. Importance of baptism to Christians

- It connects believers to Jesus' death and resurrection.
- It symbolizes leaving behind a sinful life.
- Just as Jesus rose from the dead, baptism represents a new beginning in faith.
- Sin no longer has power over those who are baptized.
- Baptism calls believers to live in a way that honors God.
- It reminds believers that they are saved by God's grace, not just by following rules.
- Baptism publicly identifies believers as members of the Christian community.
- It invites the Holy Spirit to work actively in the life of the believer.

3.18. How the Lord's Table is celebrated in church today

Luke 22:14-20

- The celebration of the Lord's Table takes place during a worship service on the Sabbath as Christians remember the resurrection of Jesus Christ.
- The congregation gathers for prayer, scripture readings and singing hymns to prepare spiritually to partake in the Eucharist.
- The religious leader reads from the Bible, often recounting the Last Supper as described in the Gospels. A prayer of thanksgiving is said, remembering Christ's sacrifice and the significance of His body and blood.
- Bread and wine are set on the altar. The religious leader offers a prayer of consecration, asking God to bless and transform them into means of grace.
- The bread is broken by the religious leader, symbolizing Christ's body.
- The congregation, in a communal setting, receives the bread and wine. This symbolizes the believer's participation in the body and blood of Christ. This act is both a personal and communal expression of faith and a reminder of Christ's sacrifice for the forgiveness of sins.
- As Christians partake in the Eucharist, the Lord's Table or the Last Supper, they reflect on the meaning of Christ's sacrifice, the grace they receive and their unity with Christ and fellow believers.

3.19. Significance of the Lord's Table in the life of a christian

- The blood of Jesus is a seal of the covenant between Christians and God.
- It reminds Christians of the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ.
- It unites Christians as they wait for the second coming of Jesus Christ.
- It is a sign of obedience to the command of Jesus Christ.
- It gives a Christian an opportunity to seek God's forgiveness of their sins.
- It reminds Christians of the redemptive acts of Jesus Christ.
- It renews the faith of a Christian.

- It reminds Christians of the saving grace we have received through Jesus Christ's sacrifice on the cross.

4. CHRISTIAN LIVING TODAY

4.1. CHRISTIAN ETHICS

4.2. Meaning of Christian ethics

- Christian ethics are moral principles that guide Christians in making decisions and living according to their faith.
- They are based on the teachings of:
 - ❖ Jesus Christ
 - ❖ the Bible
 - ❖ the apostles
 - ❖ the prophets
- Christian ethics emphasize:
 - ❖ Love
 - ❖ Justice
 - ❖ Honesty
 - ❖ Humility
 - ❖ Compassion
- These principles help believers align their actions with God's will.
- Christian ethics help believers make moral choices based on the Bible, Jesus' teachings and Christian traditions.
- They guide believers in knowing what is right or wrong in order to live according to God's will.

4.3. Sources of christian ethics

- a) The bible - Provides moral teachings and offers answers to questions related to the life of a Christian.
- b) Christian tradition - Historical teachings and practices of the Church that guide moral conduct.
- c) Conscience - The God-given ability to discern right from wrong. The conscience tells people whether it is right or wrong to do something.
- d) The teachings of the church - Includes moral guidance provided by religious leaders, church doctrines and rules.
- e) Situation ethics - Encourages reasoning about the rightness or wrongness of an act; however, believers are warned against making decisions based solely on situations.
- f) God's revelation - God reveals Himself through dreams, visions or natural events, guiding believers on how to approach certain issues.
- g) Prayer and meditation - Through prayer and meditation, believers seek God's guidance and wisdom in making ethical decisions.
- h) Community and fellowship - The Christian community supports and influences believers by providing accountability, advice and examples of moral living.

4.4. Ethical issues affecting the youth today

1. Peer pressure - Teenagers often face pressure from friends or social groups to engage in certain behaviours, even when those behaviours go against their values or beliefs. They may struggle to choose between fitting in and staying true to their principles.

2. Alcohol, drug and substance use - Many youth experiment with alcohol, drugs and other substances due to curiosity, peer influence or stress. This can lead to addiction, poor decision-making and long-term health consequences.
3. Addiction to social media - Excessive use of social media can contribute to anxiety, depression, low self-esteem, sleep disturbances, body image issues, cyberbullying and feelings of isolation.
4. Grooming and inappropriate dressing - Some youth may dress inappropriately to feel accepted, appear special or seem more desirable, often under the influence of social media trends or peer expectations.
5. Sexual immorality - Exposure to sexual content, peer influence and lack of proper guidance may lead some youth to engage in premarital sex, pornography or other immoral behaviours, which may have emotional and spiritual consequences.
6. Academic dishonesty - Pressure to succeed can push students to cheat in exams, plagiarize assignments or lie about their performance. This undermines integrity and personal development.
7. Lack of respect for authority - Some youth struggle with respecting parents, teachers and other authority figures, leading to disobedience, rebellion and even involvement in unlawful behaviour.

4.5. Cyber security

- Cyber security refers to the measures taken to protect computers, networks, data and online systems from attacks, damage or unauthorized access.
- It ensures the safety of personal information and prevents cyber threats such as hacking, viruses and identity theft. Cyber security focuses on:
 - Protecting digital information
 - Understanding online threats
 - Practicing safe internet use
- When using the internet, it is important to:
 - Avoid sharing sensitive information such as passwords, home addresses or financial details online.
 - Use unique and complex passwords to prevent unauthorized access to your accounts.
 - Avoid visiting suspicious websites or clicking on unknown links.
 - Respect other online users and report any cases of cyberbullying or online harassment.
 - Be cautious of fraudulent emails, messages or websites that ask for personal information (phishing scams).
 - Think before posting and ensure that privacy settings are enabled on social media accounts to protect your information.

4.6. Ethical regulations set for safe road use Kenya

1. Road users must follow traffic signs to maintain order and prevent accidents.
2. Drivers must adhere to speed limits set for different roads such as highways, urban areas and school zones.

3. Motor vehicle drivers and passengers must wear seatbelts while motorcyclists must wear helmets for safety.
4. Driving under the influence of alcohol or drugs is illegal and punishable by law.
5. Pedestrians should use designated crossings such as zebra crossings, footbridges or pedestrian paths.
6. All drivers must have a valid driving license issued by the National Transport and Safety Authority (NTSA).
7. Drivers should not use mobile phones while driving to avoid distractions.
8. Vehicles must be in good mechanical condition, with functioning lights, brakes and indicators.
9. Drivers should stay in their lanes and use indicators when switching lanes or turning.
10. All road users must give way to emergency vehicles such as ambulances, fire trucks and police vehicles.

4.7. Solutions to ethical issues facing youth today

1. Develop strong personal values and self-confidence to resist negative peer pressure.
2. Educate youth on the dangers of drugs and alcohol through schools and community programs.
3. Use social media responsibly to avoid cyberbullying, addiction and harmful content.
4. Dress appropriately to promote self-respect and modesty.
5. Engage in sports, arts and community service to stay active and avoid harmful behaviours.
6. Encourage open communication with parents, teachers and mentors to seek guidance when facing moral challenges.
7. Promote spiritual growth through prayer, worship and Bible study to strengthen moral decision-making.
8. Choose good friends and positive role models who influence behaviour in the right direction.
9. Set personal goals and stay focused on education or career paths to avoid distractions.
10. Attend youth seminars and church programs that teach Christian values and life skills.

4.8. Ethical values to apply in life for discipline and growth

- a) Courage - Enables youth to stand firm in their beliefs and do what is right, even when it is difficult or unpopular.
- b) Honesty - Builds trust and integrity, helping young people to be truthful in their words and actions.
- c) Respect - Promotes harmony by encouraging consideration for others including parents, teachers, peers and authority figures.
- d) Chastity - Encourages purity and self-control, helping youth make responsible choices in relationships.
- e) Diligence - Instills a strong work ethic, motivating youth to work hard, stay focused and achieve their goals.
- f) Obedience - Teaches responsibility by encouraging young people to follow rules, laws and guidance from trusted authorities.
- g) Forgiveness - Helps youth let go of anger and resentment, promoting peace and healthy relationships.

- h) Humility - Encourages modesty and a willingness to learn from others, avoiding pride and arrogance.

4.9. HUMAN RIGHTS (GENDER-BASED VIOLENCE)

4.10. Types of gender-based violence in Kenya today

1. **Physical violence** - This includes any form of physical harm such as hitting, beating or burning. It is the most visible form of gender-based violence and often results in severe injuries or death.
2. **Sexual violence** - This includes rape, sexual assault and coerced sexual acts. In Kenya, cases of sexual violence are alarmingly high, particularly during times of conflict or political instability.
3. **Emotional and psychological violence** - This is a form of violence that involves verbal abuse, threats, intimidation and humiliation. It can lead to long-term mental health issues including depression and anxiety.
4. **Economic violence** - This occurs when one partner controls the other's access to financial resources, limiting their ability to support themselves. It is often used to maintain control and power within relationships.
5. **Harmful traditional practices** - These include practices such as Female Genital Mutilation (FGM), forced marriages and child marriages in certain communities in Kenya. These practices violate the rights and dignity of women and girls.
6. **Online gender-based violence** - This form has emerged with the increased use of digital platforms. It includes cyberstalking, doxxing (publishing private information online), non-consensual sharing of intimate images and online harassment, often targeting women and girls. In Kenya, online gender-based violence exposes women to abuse on social media spaces, messaging platforms and other online forums.

4.11. Causes of gender-based violence in Kenya

1. Some traditional beliefs promote male dominance and female subordination, which leads to gender inequalities and violence.
2. Poverty and economic dependence increase vulnerability, especially for women who may lack economic independence.
3. A lack of education limits awareness about gender rights and equality, which can lead to the acceptance of gender-based violence as normal.
4. Alcohol and drug use often contribute to violent behavior including domestic violence.
5. Weak legal enforcement, including inadequate implementation of laws and lack of justice for victims, discourages reporting and accountability.
6. Social structures that favor men result in discrimination and violence against women and marginalized groups.
7. Political instability, ethnic conflicts and displacement increase vulnerability to gender-based violence.
8. The rise of digital platforms has led to increased cases of online harassment, cyberbullying and exploitation, especially targeting women and girls.

9. Harmful cultural practices such as early marriages and Female Genital Mutilation (FGM) contribute significantly to gender-based violence.

4.12. Effects of gender-based violence on individuals

Social effects of gender-based violence include:

- Survivors may face rejection from their family and society.
- Gender-based violence can strain family and community bonds.
- It may contribute to increased crime rates in affected communities.

Health effects of gender-based violence include:

- Victims may suffer from physical injuries such as bruises, fractures or even permanent disabilities.
- Anxiety, depression and suicidal thoughts are common mental health effects experienced by survivors.
- Gender-based violence can lead to unplanned pregnancies, sexually transmitted infections and complications from unsafe abortions.

Moral effects of gender-based violence include:

- Gender-based violence promotes a culture of violence and disrespect within society.
- Victims often feel ashamed, guilty or powerless as a result of their experiences.
- When justice is not served, people lose faith in the legal and moral systems.
- Some victims turn to drugs or alcohol as a way to cope with trauma.

Economic effects of gender-based violence include:

- Victims may be unable to work due to trauma or injuries sustained from violence.
- High medical expenses for treating both physical and mental health effects create financial burdens.
- Victims may lose their jobs due to stigma or lack of support in the workplace.

4.13. Effects of gender-based violence on families

- Gender-based violence often leads to separation or divorce within families.
- Children who witness violence may develop fear, aggression or struggle in their studies.
- Families may experience financial crises as a result of the violence.
- Fear and conflict create an unhealthy family environment.
- Family members may suffer from emotional trauma and stress due to ongoing violence.
- The breakdown of trust and communication can weaken family bonds.
- Gender-based violence can perpetuate cycles of violence, affecting future generations within the family.

4.14. Biblical teachings on gender-based violence

Genesis 1:26-28, Galatians 3:28

- Genesis 1:26-28 teaches that both men and women are created in the image of God and given equal dignity and authority over creation.
- This foundational truth affirms the inherent worth and equality of all people, condemning any form of violence or oppression based on gender.

- Galatians 3:28 emphasizes that in Christ, there is neither male nor female; all are one in Christ Jesus.
- This verse promotes equality and unity among all believers, rejecting discrimination or violence that divides people based on gender.
- Together, these scriptures highlight the importance of respecting and honoring all individuals equally, opposing gender-based violence as contrary to God's design for human relationships.

4.15. Values needed to avoid gender-based violence

- a) Love - Love promotes kindness, respect and understanding, helping to prevent gender-based violence. It encourages people to treat one another with dignity, resolve conflicts peacefully and create a safe and supportive society.
- b) Respect - Treating everyone with dignity, regardless of gender, fosters a culture of non-violence and mutual acceptance.
- c) Equality - Recognizing and promoting equal rights and opportunities for all helps eliminate gender discrimination and its related violence.
- d) Integrity - Standing up against gender-based violence and practicing honesty strengthens efforts to create a just and fair society.
- e) Accountability - Taking responsibility for one's actions and ensuring justice for victims discourages violence and impunity.
- f) Courage - Speaking out against gender-based violence and supporting survivors requires bravery and a commitment to meaningful change.
- g) Compassion - Showing kindness and offering support to victims fosters healing and recovery from trauma.
- h) Justice - Upholding fair treatment and ensuring that laws against gender-based violence are enforced helps protect vulnerable individuals.
- i) Self-discipline - Managing emotions and behaviors responsibly, especially in conflict situations, prevents violent actions and promotes peace.

4.16. Support services for victims of gender-based violence in Kenya

1. Trauma counselling - Helps survivors process their experiences, heal emotionally and regain confidence.
2. Psychosocial support - Provides emotional and social support to restore well-being and resilience.
3. Legal counselling - Educates victims on their rights, legal options and the process of seeking justice.
4. Family and relationship counselling - Helps rebuild trust and strengthen healthy relationships with loved ones.
5. Peer support groups - Connects survivors with others who have shared similar experiences, offering encouragement and a sense of belonging.
6. Self-empowerment programs - Provide skill training and confidence-building sessions to promote independence and self-reliance.

7. Crisis helplines - Offer immediate support, guidance and emergency assistance for those in distress.

Did you know that 1195 is Kenya's national gender-based violence helpline?

4.17. HUMAN SEXUALITY

4.18. Meaning of human sexuality

Genesis 1:27, Genesis 2:20-24, Mark 10:6-9

- Human sexuality is what makes a person male or female, boy or girl.
- God created humankind as male and female.
- In Genesis 1:27, God created humans in His image, making them male and female. This shows that gender is part of God's design.
- In Genesis 2:20-24, God created Eve as a suitable partner for Adam and they became "*one flesh*" in marriage, highlighting companionship and the deep bond between a man and a woman.
- In Mark 10:6-9, Jesus affirms that from the beginning, God made humans male and female and designed marriage as a lifelong union that should not be broken.

4.19. Christian teachings on male-female relationships

- We learn the importance of maintaining purity, respecting God's design for relationships, and avoiding immoral behaviors.
- Leviticus 18:22 condemns same-sex relationships, emphasizing that a man should not lie with another man as with a woman.
- Leviticus 20:13 reinforces the prohibition of same-sex relations, stating that it is detestable and carries serious consequences.
- Jude 1:7 refers to Sodom and Gomorrah as examples of punishment for sexual immorality and unnatural desires.
- Romans 1:26-28 describes how people turned away from God's natural order, engaging in unnatural relationships, leading to moral and spiritual consequences.
- 1 Corinthians 6:9 lists various sinful behaviors including sexual immorality, stating that those who practice them will not inherit the kingdom of God.

4.20. Dating and courtship

- **Dating** is a social stage where people meet regularly to explore if they are compatible.
- It usually does not involve any long-term commitment or plans for marriage. Dating can sometimes include physical or sexual intimacy.
- There is typically no formal accountability to family or community during dating. The focus of dating is often on personal enjoyment and getting to know each other casually.
- **Courtship** is a purposeful period during which a couple intentionally develops their relationship.
- It involves a commitment or promises to pursue marriage.
- Courtship preserves sexual intimacy exclusively for marriage. It involves accountability to parents, spiritual leaders or mentors.

- Courtship seeks to honor God's design for relationships and marriage.
- The differences between dating and courtship are:

Dating

A social activity where people meet regularly to see if they are compatible.

Does not involve a long-term commitment.

Can lead to physical or sexual intimacy before marriage.

During dating, there is often no formal accountability to family or community.

Dating tends to focus on personal enjoyment and casual interaction.

Courtship

A deliberate process focused on building a relationship with the intention of marriage.

Involves a promise or commitment to marriage.

Preserves sexual intimacy exclusively for marriage.

Courtship seeks accountability from parents, spiritual leaders or mentors.

Courtship centers on honoring God's design for relationships and preparing for marriage.

4.21. Irresponsible sexual behaviour

- Irresponsible sexual behaviour refers to actions related to sexuality that can cause harm to oneself or others, violate social or legal norms or disregard the importance of consent, safety and respect.
- This kind of behaviour often involves a lack of responsibility, awareness or care about the consequences of one's sexual actions.
- It can lead to emotional, physical, social or legal problems.

4.22. Types of irresponsible sexual behaviour

- a) Incest: Sexual relations between close family members, which are socially and legally unacceptable.
- b) Rape: Forced or non-consensual sexual activity, which is a serious crime and a violation of human rights.
- c) Prostitution: Exchanging sex for money or favors.
- d) Lesbianism: A form of homosexuality where women are attracted to other women.
- e) Bestiality: Engaging in sexual acts with animals.
- f) Adultery: Engaging in sexual relations with someone other than one's spouse.
- g) Homosexuality: Sexual attraction or relationships between people of the same sex.
- h) Fornication: Engaging in sexual activity outside of marriage.

4.23. Causes of irresponsible sexual behaviour

- Poverty may lead people to have sex in exchange for money or food.
- Lack of parental supervision can contribute to risky sexual behaviour.
- Peer pressure can cause individuals to engage in unsafe sexual activities.
- Insufficient sex education leads to ignorance about reproductive health and consequences of unprotected sex.
- Exposure to explicit content on social media can promote unhealthy attitudes toward sex.

- Alcohol and drug use impair judgment, increasing the likelihood of unprotected or unplanned sex.
- Experiences of sexual harassment such as rape and violence, can result in risky sexual behaviour.
- Curiosity often motivates young people to explore and experiment with sex.

4.24. Effects of irresponsible sexual behaviour

1. Unplanned pregnancies, which can impact the health, education and future of young people.
2. Sexually transmitted infections (STIs) including HIV/AIDS, which can have serious health consequences.
3. Emotional and psychological distress such as guilt, anxiety and depression.
4. Breakdown of relationships and family conflicts especially in cases of adultery or infidelity.
5. Social stigma and discrimination, which can lead to isolation and loss of reputation.
6. Legal consequences such as imprisonment for crimes like rape or statutory offences.
7. Reduced academic and career opportunities due to the consequences of irresponsible sexual activities.
8. Risk of sexual exploitation and abuse, especially among vulnerable individuals.

4.25. Ways of avoiding irresponsible sexual behaviour

- Practice abstinence from sexual activity.
- Say 'no' to peer pressure and promote self-respect.
- Surround yourself with friends who make good choices (keep the right company).
- Read and obey God's Word for guidance and wise decision-making.
- Avoid places where immoral activities happen such as parties with bad influences.
- Attend seminars on responsible sexual behaviour.
- Read Christian literature and other educational materials about responsible sexual behaviour.
- Communicate openly with trusted adults or mentors about sexual health and concerns.
- Develop personal goals and ambitions to stay focused on your future and avoid distractions.

4.26. Values Needed to Avoid Irresponsible Sexual Behaviour

- a) Patience - Helps you wait for the right time and avoid rushing into sexual relationships.
- b) Respect - Encourages you to value yourself and others, making it easier to honour boundaries.
- c) Courage - Gives you the strength to say 'no' to peer pressure and stand by your values.
- d) Honesty - Promotes open communication and truthfulness in relationships.
- e) Self-discipline - Enables you to control your desires and make responsible decisions.
- f) Responsibility - Helps you consider the impact of your actions on yourself and others.
- g) Faithfulness - Supports loyalty and commitment in relationships.
- h) Love - Real love is respectful, caring and protective, not selfish or harmful.

4.27. MARRIAGE AND FAMILY

- Marriage is a formal union between an adult male and an adult female who agree to live together in a long-lasting relationship as husband and wife.
- Family is a group of people connected by blood or marriage.

4.28. Christian teachings on marriage and family

Exodus 20:12, Proverbs 1:8-9, Proverbs 10:1, Proverbs 30:17, Proverbs 20:20, 1 Timothy 5:3-8, Ephesians 6:4, Colossians 3:18-21

- Exodus 20:12 teaches that children should respect and obey their parents. Honouring parents comes with a promise of blessings and long life.
- Proverbs 1:8-9 emphasizes the importance of listening to and following parental guidance. Parents' teachings provide wisdom and bring honor to children.
- Proverbs 10:1 state that a child's behaviour affects the emotional well-being of parents. Wise and obedient children bring happiness, while disobedient and foolish ones cause sorrow.
- Proverbs 30:17 warns against disrespecting parents, stating that dishonouring them leads to severe consequences.
- Proverbs 20:20 cautions against disrespecting or speaking ill of parents; this results in misfortune and loss of direction in life.
- 1 Timothy 5:3-8 highlights the responsibility of family members to care for one another, particularly for widows and those in need. Failing to do so goes against Christian faith.
- Ephesians 6:4 emphasizes that parents, especially fathers, should not treat their children harshly or unfairly, as this can lead to resentment and discouragement. Parents are encouraged to raise their children with godly values, teaching them to follow the ways of the Lord.
- Colossians 3:18-21 teaches about harmonious family relationships. Wives should respect their husbands, husbands should love their wives, children should obey their parents and fathers should treat their children with care to avoid discouraging them.

4.29. Celibacy as an alternative to marriage

Matthew 19:10-12, 1 Corinthians 7:7-9, Revelation 14:4-5

- Celibacy is the practice of abstaining from marriage and sexual activity.
- The Bible presents celibacy as a special calling or gift from God.
- In Matthew 19:10-12, Jesus speaks about celibacy in response to His teaching on marriage and divorce. His disciples remark that it might be better not to marry and Jesus responds that not everyone can accept this, but only those to whom it has been given. This implies that celibacy is a calling for some, but not all.
- In 1 Corinthians 7:7-9, Paul acknowledges that celibacy is a gift from God, just like marriage. He advises those who cannot control their desires to marry, as it is better to marry than to struggle with passion.
- Revelation 14:4-5 describes a group of believers who remained celibate, symbolizing purity and complete devotion to God. Their choice to abstain from marriage and sexual relations is seen as a spiritual commitment.

4.30. Role of church in preparing young people for marriage and family life

2 Corinthians 6:14

- a) Choosing a marriage partner: The church encourages young people to choose a marriage partner based on shared faith, values and mutual respect. Young people are advised to look for qualities such as honesty, faithfulness and responsibility. The church also warns against choosing a partner who does not share the same faith and values, as taught in 2 Corinthians 6:14.
- b) Betrothal: This is also referred to as engagement. It is a formal commitment to marry. The church supports couples during this stage through engagement counselling, helping them understand the responsibilities in marriage.
- c) Courtship: This is a period where couples get to know each other better before marriage. The church teaches the importance of chastity and encourages young people to uphold moral integrity by avoiding pre-marital sex. Many churches also encourage mentorship from married couples or elders to provide guidance and support.
- d) Wedding ceremony: This is a sacred event where a couple makes their vows before God and the congregation. The church prepares couples by offering pre-marital counselling and ensuring they understand the meaning of lifelong commitment. The exchange of vows, prayers and blessings strengthens the couple's commitment to each other.
- e) Marriage: The church continues to guide couples even after the wedding. Post-marriage counselling helps them adjust to their new life together and handle challenges. The church encourages family prayer and worship to strengthen the marriage.

4.31. Challenges facing marriage and family life

1. Many families struggle because they do not have enough money to meet their basic needs, leading to stress and conflict.
2. Differences in parenting styles often cause disagreements between spouses.
3. Interference from relatives can strain family relationships.
4. Physical or mental health problems negatively affect family stability and happiness.
5. Domestic violence causes emotional harm and breaks trust within the family.
6. Alcohol, drug, and substance abuse lead to neglect, irresponsible behaviour and family breakdown.
7. Poor communication between spouses results in misunderstandings and unresolved conflicts.
8. Infidelity or unfaithfulness weakens trust and may lead to separation or divorce.
9. Cultural and religious differences can create tension between partners.
10. Long working hours and lack of quality time reduce emotional connection between family members.
11. Raising children with special needs places additional emotional and financial strain on families.
12. Unrealistic expectations in marriage often lead to disappointment and dissatisfaction.

4.32. Solutions to problems facing families today

1. Families should spend quality time together, listen actively and resolve conflicts peacefully.
2. Open and honest communication among family members is essential and professional counselling should be sought when needed.

3. Partners should maintain mutual respect and trust to strengthen their relationship.
4. Practising financial planning and budgeting helps families manage their resources effectively.
5. Marital conflicts can be resolved through open discussions, compromise and counselling; in cases of domestic violence, victims should seek protection and families should promote peaceful conflict resolution.
6. Extended family issues should be handled with respect by setting boundaries and solving disagreements calmly.
7. Parents should provide consistent guidance and support to children to foster a positive family environment.
8. Families should encourage forgiveness and understanding to heal past hurts and build stronger relationships.
9. Couples and families should engage in regular spiritual activities such as prayer and worship, to strengthen their bond and values.

4.33. Values that contribute to stable families

1. Love and care - Showing affection and concern for each family member.
2. Respect - Honouring each person's opinions, feelings and boundaries.
3. Trust - Being reliable and honest with each other.
4. Responsibility - Fulfilling family roles and obligations.
5. Communication - Openly expressing thoughts and listening actively.
6. Commitment - Staying dedicated to family well-being and unity.
7. Patience - Understanding and accepting each other's differences.
8. Forgiveness - Letting go of grudges and resolving conflicts peacefully.
9. Teamwork - Working together to achieve family goals.

4.34. CHRISTIAN RESPONSE TO MODERN MEDICINE, SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

4.35. Role of technology in spreading the gospel

- Technology has contributed to the spread of the Gospel in many ways. Social media and online platforms such as Facebook, YouTube, Instagram and TikTok allow churches and ministries to share sermons, Bible teachings and devotionals with a global audience.
- Churches can broadcast their services in real-time, reaching believers who cannot attend physically.
- Churches use emails and messaging apps like WhatsApp and Telegram to share devotionals, prayer requests and updates with their members.
- Digital books and online courses help in discipleship and deeper biblical studies.
- Christians produce films, movies, animations and videos to preach the Gospel, communicating biblical messages in creative ways.
- The printing press assists in publishing Christian magazines, Bibles and other literature.
- Musical instruments such as pianos and guitars are used during praise and worship to enhance the worship experience.

4.36. Christian views on euthanasia

- Euthanasia is the act of intentionally ending a person's life to relieve them from suffering, usually due to a terminal illness or severe pain. It is practised with the sick person's consent.
- It can be done by injecting an overdose of sleeping pills, switching off life support machines, or even exposing a person with chronic pneumonia to very cold air.
- Some of the Christian views on euthanasia are:
 - a) It is a form of murder.
 - b) Life is sacred, a gift from God and only He can take away human life.
 - c) It deprives relatives, friends and family of the opportunity to give love and care to the dying person.
 - d) Euthanasia discourages patients and makes them lose hope in life, causing them to feel unwanted and rejected.
 - e) Jesus has power over sickness and through His name, all sicknesses can be healed.
 - f) Suffering is part of a Christian's life according to the teachings of Jesus and therefore cannot be used to justify euthanasia.
 - g) It discourages medical research on vaccines that may cure various diseases.

4.37. Defending the right to life according to the word of God

Exodus 20:13, Genesis 9:6, Acts 17:25, Matthew 5:21, Proverbs 6:16-17

- Life is sacred because every person is made in God's image.
- God commands us not to kill; His commandment directly protects human life by forbidding the unjust taking of life.
- The Word of God emphasizes that life comes from God and only God has authority over it.
- Human life is valuable and must be treated with dignity and respect at all stages.
- Taking a life unjustly goes against God's justice and disrupts the harmony He intended for humanity.
- Christians are called to protect and preserve life, reflecting God's love and compassion for all people.

4.38. Christian views on cosmetic plastic surgery

1 Samuel 16:7, Proverbs 31:30, Leviticus 19:28, 1 Peter 3:3-4, 1 Corinthians 6:19-20, Psalms 139:14

- Cosmetic plastic surgery is a type of surgery done to enhance a person's appearance. It aims to improve features and overall look rather than for medical reasons.
- Common procedures include facelifts, nose reshaping, liposuction and breast enhancement. The goal is to improve how people look and feel about themselves.
- The Christian teachings on cosmetic plastic surgery include the following:
 - a) God values inner character over physical beauty, implying that external appearance should not be a primary concern. (1 Samuel 16:7)
 - b) Inner godliness is more important than physical beauty, which fades over time. It encourages focusing on spiritual growth rather than external appearance. (Proverbs 31:30)
 - c) God warns against making any cutting on our body. (Leviticus 19:28)

- d) True beauty comes from a godly character rather than external enhancements, suggesting that seeking beauty through surgery may not align with biblical principles. (1 Peter 3:3-4)
- e) We are reminded to respect our bodies as temples of God. Altering the body through surgery is a form of dishonouring it. (1 Corinthians 6:19-20)
- f) God created each person with care and purpose. We should embrace our natural appearance as part of God's perfect design. (Psalms 139:14)

4.39. Creative skills outlined in the bible

- Exodus 31:1-6
 - 1. Artistic design: Skilled in crafting beautiful objects.
 - 2. Metalwork: Working with gold, silver, and bronze.
 - 3. Carving: Engraving stones and working with wood.
- 2 Chronicles 26:14-15
 - 1. Engineering: Designing and building war machines for defence.
- John 1:1-3
 - 1. Metalwork and mechanics: Creating catapults and devices for warfare.
 - 2. This verse emphasizes divine creativity, showing that God is involved in the creation of everything.
- Exodus 35:30-35
 - 1. Weaving and embroidery: Skilled in making intricate cloth and decorative materials.
 - 2. Teaching and imparting craftsmanship to others.
- Genesis 4:20-22
 - 1. Music: Jubal is described as the father of all who play the harp and flute.
 - 2. Metalworking: Tubal-cain is noted as a forger of all instruments of bronze and iron.
 - 3. Livestock management and herding: Skills important for sustaining communities.
- Psalm 33:3
 - 1. Music composition and singing: Praising God through creative music.

4.40. Lessons learnt from Daniel and King Solomon's aptitude and wisdom

Daniel 1:17-20, Daniel 5:11-12, Daniel 2:24-49, 2 Chronicles 1:7-12

- Aptitude is a natural ability to do something.
- Wisdom is a gift from God, as demonstrated in the lives of Daniel and King Solomon. Their wisdom enabled them to lead, interpret mysteries and make sound judgments.
- Some of the lessons learnt from Daniel and King Solomon's aptitude and wisdom are:
 - God grants wisdom and understanding; hence true wisdom comes from God.
 - Those who remain faithful to God are blessed with knowledge and discernment.
 - True wisdom comes from God, not from human sources. Daniel sought God in prayer before interpreting the dream.
 - We should be humble like Daniel, who gave credit to God rather than taking glory for himself. Solomon recognized that he needed God's wisdom to govern his people.
 - God reveals mysteries to those who seek Him faithfully.
 - Wisdom can bring favour before rulers and lead to positions of influence.

- Seeking wisdom over material wealth is pleasing to God.
- God rewards those who ask for wisdom with more than they expect.
- Godly wisdom enables leaders to be just and righteous.
- Wisdom and understanding make a person valuable.